

U.S. HISTORY HACK

Unit 6

World War II

*Totalitarianism · American Entry · Battles & Leaders · Home Front · Atomic Bomb ·
Postwar Order · 1919–1945*

Standards US.45 – US.58

US.45

US.46

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US.58

Where We Are Headed

Unit 6 · World War II (1919–1945) — the Rise of Totalitarianism, American Entry, the War Fronts, the Home Front, and the Postwar Order



BELL RINGER · HOOK

How did the United States move from neutrality to total war — and what did victory cost, both abroad and at home?

On December 7, 1941, Japanese planes struck the U.S. fleet at Pearl Harbor, and a nation that had tried to stay out of Europe's war was pulled fully into the largest conflict in human history.

Across the next four years the United States would mobilize its factories, its people, and its science — and confront choices about freedom, sacrifice, and power that still shape the world today.

TURN & TALK

With a partner, list three reasons a country might try to stay out of a foreign war, and one thing that could force it to fight anyway. Then predict: once the U.S. entered WWII, whose lives at home would change the most? Keep your list; we will return to it at the end of the unit.

How This Deck Works — UDL 3.0 & MTSS

Teacher reference · CAST UDL 3.0 guidelines designed into every standard

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

ENGAGEMENT

Multiple means of the “why”

- Welcoming Interests & Identities
- Sustaining Effort & Persistence
- Emotional Capacity

REPRESENTATION

Multiple means of the “what”

- Perception
- Language & Symbols
- Building Knowledge

ACTION & EXPRESSION

Multiple means of the “how”

- Interaction
- Expression & Communication
- Strategy Development

MTSS decision cycle: Tier 1 core for all → the Progress Check yields evidence → below mastery routes to targeted reteach (Tier 2, Teacher Guide §16); at/above mastery routes to extension. **The goal never lowers.**

STANDARD

US.45

*Rise and Spread of Fascism,
Communism, and Totalitarianism*

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the rise and spread of fascism, communism, and totalitarianism internationally.

I CAN

I can explain the rise and spread of fascism, communism, and totalitarianism internationally, including the key characteristics and leaders of each system.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

Unit 5 What era did we just finish, and how did it set the stage for the 1930s?

2

Unit Hook What is the big question of Unit 6?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Name one totalitarian dictator who rose to power before World War II.

✓ **ANSWER**

Adolf Hitler (Germany), Benito Mussolini (Italy), or Joseph Stalin (Soviet Union).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the 1920s and 1930s, as democracies struggled with depression and the wreckage of World War I, new dictators, Mussolini, Hitler, and Stalin, promised order, glory, and revenge, and millions of desperate people handed them total power.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why would free people willingly give up their liberty to a dictator, and what makes fascism, communism, and totalitarianism so dangerous?

US.45 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Fascism

say: *FASH-iz-um*

Fascismo

An authoritarian political ideology that emphasizes extreme nationalism, militarism, totalitarian control, and a dictatorial leader. Suppresses opposition and glorifies the state above individual rights.

Totalitarianism

say: *toh-tal-ih-TAIR-ee-uh-niz-um*

Totalitarismo

A system of government where the state controls every aspect of public and private life, using propaganda, secret police, and terror to eliminate opposition.

Communism

say: *KOM-yoo-niz-um*

Comunismo

A political and economic system in which the state owns property and the means of production in the name of the working class; in the 20th century it took the form of one-party dictatorship under leaders like Lenin and Stalin.

Adolf Hitler

say: *AY-dolf HIT-ler*

Adolf Hitler

Nazi dictator of Germany (1933-1945) who led Germany into World War II and orchestrated the Holocaust, resulting in the deaths of 6 million Jews and millions of others.

Benito Mussolini

say: *beh-NEE-toh moo-suh-LEE-nee*

Benito Mussolini

Fascist dictator of Italy (1922-1943) who created the first fascist state, formed the Axis alliance with Hitler, and led Italy into World War II.

Joseph Stalin

say: *JOH-zef STAH-lin*

Joseph Stalin

Communist dictator of the Soviet Union (1924-1953) who ruled through terror, forced collectivization, and purges, resulting in millions of deaths.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Key Characteristics of Fascism

- Fascism is characterized by ultranationalism (extreme devotion to nation above individual rights), authoritarian leadership with dictatorial power concentrated in a single leader (Führer, Duce), and militarism glorifying war and aggressive expansion.
- Fascists violently opposed communism and socialism, used mass mobilization through rallies and propaganda, and created a cult of personality around their leaders.
- They also scapegoated minority groups for national problems while maintaining a corporate state with government control of the economy.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Fascism, communism, and totalitarianism were alike because _____, but they differed in _____.

Fundamental Tenets of Communism

- Communism is based on class struggle as the driving force of history, requiring a proletarian revolution where the working class overthrows capitalism.
- It promotes collective ownership with state control of production and property, aiming for a classless society.
- Communists viewed their revolution as an international movement, led by a vanguard Communist Party governing on behalf of workers.
- The system relies on central planning where government directs all economic activity, and historically promoted atheism, opposing organized religion.

Totalitarianism in Italy, Germany, and Soviet Union

- Totalitarianism is a political system where government exercises complete control over all public and private life.
- In Italy, Benito Mussolini ("Il Duce") established fascist dictatorship (1922-1943), using Blackshirts to intimidate opponents.
- In the Soviet Union, Joseph Stalin consolidated power after Lenin's death, implementing Five-Year Plans, forced collectivization causing famine, and the Great Purge eliminating millions.
- In Germany, Adolf Hitler ("Führer") established Nazi dictatorship (1933-1945), promoting Aryan supremacy and anti-Semitism, using the Gestapo secret police, and seeking "Lebensraum" through territorial expansion.



Charles Russell (donor) / National Archives and Records Administration (NARA), September 1935 [National Archives](#)

Factors Facilitating International Spread

- Common factors enabling totalitarianism included the Great Depression creating conditions for radical solutions, political instability with weak democratic governments, social upheaval from war and revolution, charismatic leaders promising simple solutions, and mass communication enabling propaganda.
- The League of Nations' weakness, Western appeasement policies, and economic nationalism allowed aggression to go unchallenged.
- German rearmament, Italian conquest of Ethiopia, and Japanese expansion in Asia demonstrated international system breakdown.

Key Figures

Adolf Hitler

Nazi dictator of Germany (1889-1945)

- Built a totalitarian one-party state after 1933
- Preached ultranationalism, racism, and endless expansion
- Launched the aggression that started WWII in Europe

STRATEGY Use Hitler to define fascism/totalitarianism from a real regime, not an abstraction.

Joseph Stalin

Soviet dictator (1878-1953)

- Turned the USSR into a totalitarian communist state
- Used purges, gulags, and terror to hold power
- Later joined the Allies against Hitler

STRATEGY Pair Stalin with Hitler so students see totalitarianism on both the far left and far right.

US.45 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

The Doctrine of Fascism

Argumentation

Benito Mussolini • 1932

"The Fascist State organizes the nation, but leaves a sufficient margin of liberty to the individual; the latter is deprived of all useless and possibly harmful freedom, but retains what is essential; the deciding power in this question cannot be the individual, but the State alone... The Fascist conception of the State is all-embracing; outside of it no human or spiritual values can exist, much less have value."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

By 1932, Europe was in political turmoil as the Great Depression shook democratic governments to their foundations. Mussolini had already seized power in Italy in 1922 and was building a new kind of authoritarian state called fascism, which prioritized the nation and state above all individual rights. His ideas were spreading, influencing Hitler's rise in Germany and threatening democratic values worldwide.

ANALYZE

According to this excerpt, what is the Fascist view of the relationship between the individual and the State?

SOURCE IT	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
FIRST SSR.02 • before you interpret	Benito Mussolini	1932	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Internet Archive](#)

Let's Work One Together

Compare authoritarian systems

MODEL PROMPT: What do fascism and communism share, and where do they split?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Both crush individual rights and opposition under one party. They split on economics: fascism keeps private property under state control; communism abolishes it. The tool - total control - is the same.

THINK ALOUD

In the section, underline one shared trait and one difference.

→ **Now you try:** *With a partner, name the single feature that makes a government 'totalitarian,' citing a line.*

US.45 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Three Roads to Dictatorship — Comparing Fascism, Communism, and Totalitarianism

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and Mussolini's 'Doctrine of Fascism' excerpt, build a comparison chart with three columns: FASCISM, COMMUNISM, and TOTALITARIANISM. For each, record its core belief, one leader (Mussolini, Hitler, Stalin), and how it controlled its people. Add one factor that helped these systems spread after World War I (economic depression, fear, nationalism, weak democracies). Finish with a one-sentence claim naming what all three systems had in common.

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-column comparison chart (belief, leader, method of control, plus one spread factor) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about their shared features.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the three systems pre-labeled and a word bank of beliefs, leaders, and control methods to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph arguing whether fascism and communism were opposites or mirror images, using Mussolini's words as evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us45-fascism-communism-totalitarianism.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us45-fascism-communism-totalitarianism.pdf)

US.45 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

"Germany alone is not to blame for this war. The atmosphere of militarism that has poisoned Europe — the arms race, the secret treaties, the nationalism that inflames every petty dispute — has made this catastrophe inevitable." — Socialist Newspaper Vorwärts, Berlin, August 1914

- A** Extreme nationalism, economic grievances, and militarism created conditions in which charismatic demagogues could rise to power by exploiting popular anger.
- B** Communist revolutions swept through Europe, and fascist dictators rose as the only force capable of stopping communism's spread.
- C** Democratic parties lost elections in Germany, Italy, and Japan, peacefully transferring power to fascist parties through legitimate processes.
- D** Economic prosperity in the 1920s created excessive confidence that led nations to pursue reckless expansionist policies.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

Read the excerpt below.

✓ ANSWER KEY

"Germany alone is not to blame for this war. The atmosphere of militarism that has poisoned Europe — the arms race, the secret treaties, the nationalism that inflames every petty dispute — has made this catastrophe inevitable." — Socialist Newspaper Vorwärts, Berlin, August 1914

Which of the following best describes the rise of dictators and extreme nationalism as a long-

- A** Extreme nationalism, economic grievances, and militarism created conditions in which charismatic demagogues could rise to power by exploiting popular anger. ✓
- B** Communist revolutions swept through Europe, and fascist dictators rose as the only force capable of stopping communism's spread.
- C** Democratic parties lost elections in Germany, Italy, and Japan, peacefully transferring power to fascist parties through legitimate processes.
- D** Economic prosperity in the 1920s created excessive confidence that led nations to pursue reckless expansionist policies.

Correct answer: A. Why: The excerpt describes how extreme nationalism, militarism, and an arms race created the conditions for WWI. These same forces — extreme nationalism, economic grievance, and militarism — fueled the rise of fascist dictators like Hitler, Mussolini, and military regimes in Japan in the 1930s. Hitler exploited economic collapse and nationalist grievance to seize power in Germany.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Key Characteristics of Fascism
- Fundamental Tenets of Communism
- Totalitarianism in Italy, Germany, and Soviet Union
- Factors Facilitating International Spread

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Were fascism and communism true opposites or mirror images of each other? Argue your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how fascism, communism, and totalitarianism are alike and different, and name one factor that helped them spread after World War I.

Words you need before we read

Fascism

En español: *Fascismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

An authoritarian political ideology that emphasizes extreme nationalism, militarism, totalitarian control, and a dictatorial leader. Suppresses opposition and glorifies the state above individual rights.

Totalitarianism

En español: *Totalitarismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A system of government where the state controls every aspect of public and private life, using propaganda, secret police, and terror to eliminate opposition.

Communism

En español: *Comunismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A political and economic system in which the state owns property and the means of production in the name of the working class; in the 20th century it took the form of one-party dictatorship under leaders like Lenin and Stalin.

Check your understanding

How did economic crisis and political instability enable the rise of totalitarian regimes in Italy, Germany, and the Soviet Union?

- A** The Great Depression, post-WWI disappointment, and political chaos created conditions where people accepted radical solutions and strong leaders promising stability ✓ KEY
- B** Economic prosperity led people to seek stronger government control, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which does not align with the documented historical record
- C** Totalitarian regimes rose during periods of peace and prosperity, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** Democratic governments actively promoted totalitarianism, which does not align with the documented historical record, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.46

FDR's Response to World Crises

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain President Franklin D. Roosevelt's response to world crises, including: The Quarantine Speech, the Four Freedoms speech, the Atlantic Charter, and the Lend-Lease Act.

I CAN

I can explain President Franklin D. Roosevelt's response to world crises, including the Quarantine Speech, the Four Freedoms speech, the Atlantic Charter, and the Lend-Lease Act.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.45 Name the three totalitarian systems and one leader of each.

2

US.45 What is totalitarianism?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Before entering the war, what policy did the U.S. use to aid the Allies with weapons and supplies?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Lend-Lease Act of 1941.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

As Europe fell to Hitler and Japan expanded across the Pacific, a still-neutral United States watched, until President Roosevelt began step by step to turn the nation into what he called the 'great arsenal of democracy.'

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How does a president move a reluctant, isolationist nation toward war without ever firing a shot?

US.46 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Quarantine Speech

say: KWOR-un-teen speech

Discurso de la Cuarentena

FDR's 1937 address proposing that peace-loving nations 'quarantine' aggressor states to halt the spread of international lawlessness.

Four Freedoms Speech

say: for FREE-dumz speech

Discurso de las Cuatro Libertades

FDR's 1941 speech defining American war aims: freedom of speech, freedom of worship, freedom from want, and freedom from fear.

Lend-Lease Act (1941)

say: lend lees akt

Ley de Préstamo y Arriendo (1941)

U.S. program allowing the President to lend or lease war supplies to any nation deemed vital to American defense, primarily Britain and the Soviet Union.

Appeasement

say: uh-PEEZ-ment

Apaciguamiento

Policy of making concessions to aggressive powers to avoid conflict. Britain's PM Chamberlain practiced appeasement with Hitler at the Munich Conference (1938), allowing Germany to annex the Sudetenland from Czechoslovakia.

Axis Powers

say: AK-sis POW-erz

Potencias del Eje

Military alliance of Germany, Italy, and Japan during World War II. United by shared goals of territorial expansion, militarism, and opposition to democratic nations.

Allied Powers

say: AL-yd POW-erz

Potencias Aliadas

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Quarantine Speech (October 5, 1937)

- As Japan invaded China and European tensions grew, Roosevelt faced strong isolationist sentiment reflected in the Neutrality Acts (1935-1937).
- In his Quarantine Speech, FDR compared aggressor nations to a disease requiring quarantine, suggesting peace-loving nations should cooperate against aggressors.
- This was the first major departure from strict isolationism, laying groundwork for later interventionist policies, though public reaction was mixed and no immediate policy changes resulted.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

FDR moved the U.S. away from neutrality by _____ and _____, which helped the Allies because _____.

Four Freedoms Speech (January 6, 1941)

- Roosevelt outlined four essential freedoms that should exist "everywhere in the world": Freedom of Speech and Expression, Freedom of Worship, Freedom from Want (economic security), and Freedom from Fear (reduction of armaments).
- These freedoms provided moral justification for U.S. involvement in war, defined what America would fight for, and outlined goals for post-war international order.
- The Four Freedoms contrasted democratic values with fascist oppression and later influenced the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.



OWI / U.S. Government, September 11, 1941 [National Archives](#)

Atlantic Charter (August 14, 1941)

- Meeting secretly with Winston Churchill off Newfoundland, Roosevelt established war aims and post-war principles: no territorial aggrandizement, self-determination for peoples, economic cooperation and free trade, freedom of the seas, disarmament after war, and collective security through international organization.
- The Charter became the foundation for the United Nations, encouraged decolonization movements, and established precedents for international human rights law.

Lend-Lease Act (March 11, 1941)

- The Lend-Lease Act allowed the U.S. to provide military equipment to Britain without requiring immediate payment, circumventing neutrality while making America the "Arsenal of Democracy." Eventually totaling \$50 billion, aid went primarily to Britain (60%), Soviet Union (20%), and China.
- The program enabled British survival, supported Soviet resistance to German invasion, and stimulated U.S. industrial production while effectively ending true American neutrality.

Key Figure

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President; responding to world crises

- Gave the 1937 Quarantine Speech warning against aggressors
- Won Lend-Lease (1941) to arm Britain short of war
- Framed the fight as defending the 'Four Freedoms'

STRATEGY Trace FDR's steps from neutrality toward intervention - each speech and law moves the line.

US.46 · PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

The Four Freedoms Speech

Close Reading

President Franklin D. Roosevelt · January 6, 1941

"In the future days, which we seek to make secure, we look forward to a world founded upon four essential human freedoms. The first is freedom of speech and expression—everywhere in the world. The second is freedom of every person to worship God in his own way—everywhere in the world. The third is freedom from want... The fourth is freedom from fear."

READ CLOSELY *Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.*

CONTEXT

In January 1941, World War II was raging in Europe and Asia, but the United States had not yet entered the conflict. Many Americans wanted to stay out of foreign wars, a position called isolationism. Roosevelt used this address—his annual State of the Union—to argue that America had a stake in a free world and to prepare the public for a more active role in supporting democracies under attack.

ANALYZE

What is the main argument President Roosevelt makes in this excerpt?

SOURCE IT	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
FIRST <i>SSR.02 · before you interpret</i>	President Franklin D. Roosevelt	January 6, 1941	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Let's Work One Together

Trace a leader's shifting policy

MODEL PROMPT: How did FDR move America closer to war without declaring it?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Step by step: the Quarantine Speech named the danger, Lend-Lease armed the Allies, and the Four Freedoms defined the cause. Each move edged past neutrality.

THINK ALOUD

List FDR's actions in order and label each 'more neutral' or 'more involved.'

→ **Now you try:** *Pick the boldest step short of war and defend your choice with evidence.*

US.46 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

From Neutral to Arsenal — Tracking FDR's Response

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Four Freedoms speech excerpt and use your notes to build a timeline of FDR's four key responses to the world crisis: the Quarantine Speech (1937), the Four Freedoms speech (Jan 1941), the Lend-Lease Act (March 1941), and the Atlantic Charter (Aug 1941). For each, write one sentence on what it did and how it moved the U.S. away from strict neutrality. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether FDR was leading the nation toward war or trying to keep it out.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-step timeline (one sentence each on purpose + move away from neutrality) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about FDR's intent.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Timeline with the four events pre-placed and a word bank of descriptions to match. Honors: Write a paragraph using the Four Freedoms speech to explain how FDR framed aid to the Allies as a defense of democracy itself.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us46-fdr-response-world-crises.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us46-fdr-response-world-crises.pdf)

US.46 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What was the primary significance of FDR's Quarantine Speech of 1937 in relation to American foreign policy?

- A** It committed the United States to immediately entering the war against Nazi Germany.
- B** It suggested that aggressive nations should be isolated, signaling a possible shift away from strict neutrality.
- C** It announced the creation of the Lend-Lease program to supply weapons to Allied nations.
- D** It declared that the U.S. would defend any nation attacked by a foreign aggressor.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What was the primary significance of FDR's Quarantine Speech of 1937 in relation to American foreign policy?

- A** It committed the United States to immediately entering the war against Nazi Germany.
- B** It suggested that aggressive nations should be isolated, signaling a possible shift away from strict neutrality. ✓
- C** It announced the creation of the Lend-Lease program to supply weapons to Allied nations.
- D** It declared that the U.S. would defend any nation attacked by a foreign aggressor.

Correct answer: B. Why: In the Quarantine Speech, FDR compared aggressive nations to a disease epidemic and suggested that the international community might need to 'quarantine' them — hinting at collective action against aggressor states and marking a cautious move away from strict neutrality, though public and congressional isolationism still limited how far he could go.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Quarantine Speech (October 5, 1937)
- Four Freedoms Speech (January 6, 1941)
- Atlantic Charter (August 14, 1941)
- Lend-Lease Act (March 11, 1941)

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: Was FDR leading the nation toward war or genuinely trying to keep it out?
Argue with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how FDR moved the U.S. from neutrality toward supporting the Allies. Give at least two specific actions.

Words you need before we read

■ Quarantine Speech

En español: *Discurso de la Cuarentena*

WHAT IT MEANS

FDR's 1937 address proposing that peace-loving nations 'quarantine' aggressor states to halt the spread of international lawlessness.

■ Four Freedoms Speech

En español: *Discurso de las Cuatro Libertades*

WHAT IT MEANS

FDR's 1941 speech defining American war aims: freedom of speech, freedom of worship, freedom from want, and freedom from fear.

■ Lend-Lease Act (1941)

En español: *Ley de Préstamo y Arriendo (1941)*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. program allowing the President to lend or lease war supplies to any nation deemed vital to American defense, primarily Britain and the Soviet Union.

Check your understanding

How did the Atlantic Charter establish principles for the post-war international order?

- A** It focused only on immediate military strategy, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- B** It established principles including self-determination, free trade, collective security, and disarmament that became the foundation for the United Nations and post-war international law ✓ KEY
- C** It divided the world into American and British spheres of influence, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D** It had no lasting impact on international relations, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.47

U.S. Response to the Holocaust

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the response of the U.S. to the plight of European Jews before the start of the war, the U.S. liberation of concentration camps during the war, and the immigration of Holocaust survivors after the war.

I CAN

I can analyze the response of the U.S. to the plight of European Jews before the war, the liberation of concentration camps during the war, and the immigration of Holocaust survivors after the war.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.46 What was the Lend-Lease Act?

2

US.46 What were the 'Four Freedoms' FDR named?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What name is given to the Nazi genocide of six million Jews?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Holocaust.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

By 1945, Allied soldiers opening the gates of Nazi concentration camps found horrors almost beyond belief, six million Jews and millions of others murdered in a state-organized genocide the world had failed to stop.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

What did the United States and the world know about the Holocaust, when did they know it, and what did they do, or fail to do, about it?

US.47 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Holocaust

say: HOL-uh-kawst

Holocausto

Nazi Germany's systematic genocide of 6 million Jews and millions of others (Roma, disabled, homosexuals, political opponents) during World War II.

Nuremberg Laws (1935)

say: NOOR-em-berg lawz

Leyes de Nuremberg (1935)

Nazi racial laws that stripped Jews of German citizenship, banned intermarriage between Jews and non-Jews, and defined "Jewishness" by ancestry. They institutionalized anti-Semitic persecution.

Adolf Hitler

say: AY-dolf HIT-ler

Adolf Hitler

Nazi dictator of Germany (1933-1945) who led Germany into World War II and orchestrated the Holocaust, resulting in the deaths of 6 million Jews and millions of others.

Totalitarianism

say: toh-tal-ih-TAIR-ee-uh-niz-um

Totalitarismo

A system of government where the state controls every aspect of public and private life, using propaganda, secret police, and terror to eliminate opposition.

Appeasement

say: uh-PEEZ-ment

Apaciguamiento

Policy of making concessions to aggressive powers to avoid conflict. Britain's PM Chamberlain practiced appeasement with Hitler at the Munich Conference (1938), allowing Germany to annex the Sudetenland from Czechoslovakia.

Axis Powers

say: AK-sis POW-erz

Potencias del Eje

Military alliance of Germany, Italy, and Japan during World War II. United by shared goals of territorial expansion, militarism, and opposition to democratic nations.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

U.S. Response Before the War

- The National Origins Act (1924) limited immigration from Eastern and Southern Europe where most Jews lived.
- The quota system severely restricted Jewish immigration, and U.S. consuls often denied visas.
- The St. Louis incident (1939) saw a ship carrying 937 Jewish refugees turned away from U.S. ports.
- The Evian Conference (1938) failed to increase refugee admissions.
- American anti-Semitism, isolationism, economic concerns during the Depression, and security fears all limited response.
- The War Refugee Board wasn't created until 1944.

SENTENCE FRAME *(EL & writing support)*

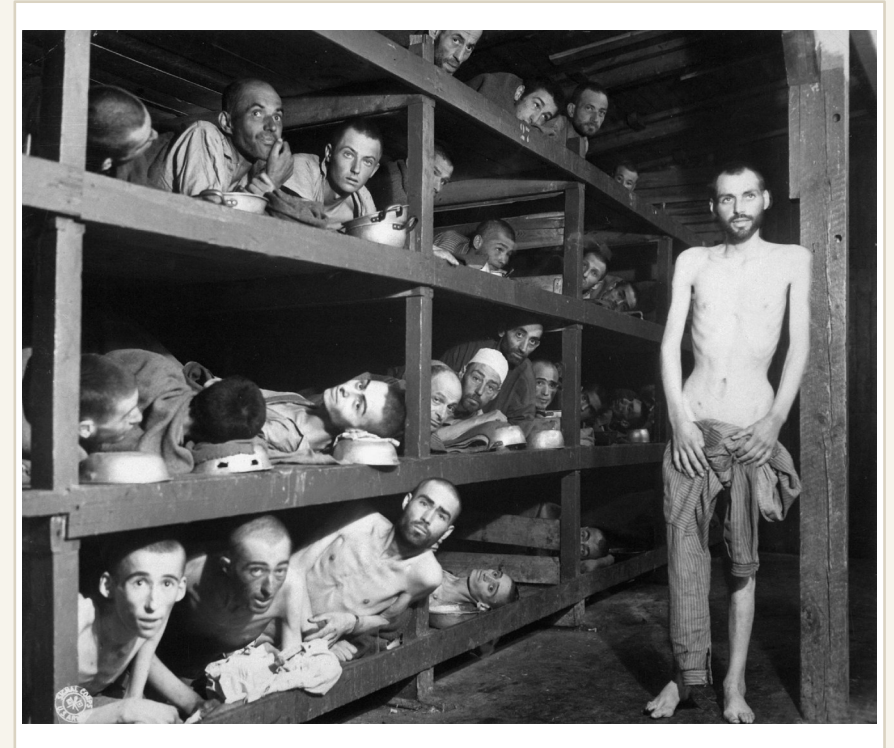
Before the war the U.S. responded to the Holocaust by _____, and during the war it _____.

US.47 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

2 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Liberation of Concentration Camps

- Soviet forces liberated Majdanek (1944) and Auschwitz (1945), while U.S. forces liberated Buchenwald, Dachau, and Mauthausen.
- American soldiers were unprepared for the extent of Nazi atrocities.
- Military photographers documented evidence while medical personnel treated survivors.
- The Army provided food, medical care, and shelter, forced local German civilians to view camps, and established displaced persons camps.
- Liberation footage shocked the American public and provided evidence for the Nuremberg trials.



Private H. Miller / U.S. Army Signal Corps, April 16, 1945 [National Archives](#)

Post-War Immigration of Holocaust Survivors

- The Displaced Persons Act (1948) initially admitted 205,000 displaced persons but gave preference to Baltic refugees over Jews.
- Amendments in 1950 expanded the program, eventually admitting about 80,000 Jewish survivors.
- Survivors faced bureaucratic delays, quota limitations, and anti-Semitic opposition.
- Jewish organizations provided financial and social support, helping survivors integrate into American society, rebuild careers, and preserve Holocaust memory through testimonies.

Moral and Ethical Implications (Honors)

- Kristallnacht (November 9-10, 1938) was a coordinated Nazi attack on Jewish businesses and synagogues.
- The U.S. recalled its ambassador and extended tourist visas but maintained immigration quotas.
- This raises questions about whether the U.S. should have done more to help Jewish refugees, the responsibility of bystander nations during genocide, and the tension between moral obligations and national security concerns.
- These events contributed to the development of genocide prevention and international human rights law.

Key Figure

Elie Wiesel

Holocaust survivor & witness (1928-2016)

- Survived Auschwitz and Buchenwald as a teenager
- Bore witness so the genocide could not be denied
- His testimony makes the Holocaust a human, documented reality

STRATEGY Use survivor testimony to move from statistics to individual human evidence.

US.47 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Testimony of Holocaust Survivor

Contextualization

Elie Wiesel • 1945 (describing liberation)

"On April 10, there were still some 20,000 prisoners in the camp, including several hundred children. It was decided to evacuate all of us at once... On April 11, at about six o'clock in the evening, the first American tanks stood at the gates of Buchenwald. Our first act as free men was to throw ourselves onto the provisions. That's all we thought about. Nothing else mattered."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

The Holocaust was Nazi Germany's systematic murder of six million Jews and millions of others during World War II. By April 1945, Allied armies were liberating concentration camps like Buchenwald and discovering the horrific conditions inside. Elie Wiesel, a Holocaust survivor who would later win the Nobel Peace Prize, was one of the survivors liberated at Buchenwald on April 11, 1945.

ANALYZE

What does this excerpt reveal about the condition of concentration camp prisoners at liberation?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSR.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

Elie Wiesel

WHEN?

1945 (describing liberation)

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [United States Holocaust Memorial Museum](#)

Let's Work One Together

Weigh evidence of a response

MODEL PROMPT: Did the U.S. do enough for Europe's Jews before and during the war?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The survivor testimony shows the horror; the Treasury report shows officials knew and delayed. Judge the response against what was known at the time, not only hindsight.

THINK ALOUD

Find one detail showing what U.S. officials knew and one showing what they did.

→ **Now you try:** *Take a position on whether the response was adequate, citing both sources.*

US.47 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Knowledge and Response — The U.S. and the Holocaust

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the survivor testimony excerpt and study the Buchenwald liberation photograph. Complete a three-part organizer: (1) BEFORE THE WAR, how the U.S. responded to European Jews seeking refuge; (2) DURING THE WAR, the liberation of the concentration camps; (3) AFTER THE WAR, the immigration of survivors. Add one specific detail per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim, supported by evidence, on what responsibility nations have when they learn of genocide.

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-part organizer (before / during / after, one detail each)
AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about national responsibility.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the three time periods pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph analyzing why the liberation photographs became such powerful evidence, using details you can see in the image.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us47-us-response-holocaust.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us47-us-response-holocaust.pdf)

US.47 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did the U.S. respond to the Holocaust before entering World War II?

- A** Maintained strict immigration quotas and turned away refugee ships like St. Louis.
- B** Military alliance between fascist and militarist powers Italy, Germany, and Japan.
- C** Establish German racial supremacy and expand living space (Lebensraum) eastward.
- D** 1934 Nazi purge eliminating Hitler's political rivals and consolidating power.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the U.S. respond to the Holocaust before entering World War II?

- A** Maintained strict immigration quotas and turned away refugee ships like St. Louis. ✓
- B** Military alliance between fascist and militarist powers Italy, Germany, and Japan.
- C** Establish German racial supremacy and expand living space (Lebensraum) eastward.
- D** 1934 Nazi purge eliminating Hitler's political rivals and consolidating power.

Correct answer: A. Why: Maintained strict immigration quotas and turned away refugee ships like St. Louis. Nazi antisemitism moved from discrimination to mass murder, killing about six million Jews and millions of other victims. B is incorrect because it describes a different program, event, or idea than this Holocaust question.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- U.S. Response Before the War
- Liberation of Concentration Camps
- Post-War Immigration of Holocaust Survivors
- Moral and Ethical Implications (Honors)

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: Given what the U.S. knew, did it do enough to respond to the Holocaust?
Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe the U.S. response to the Holocaust before, during, and after the war. Give one specific example from each period.

Words you need before we read

Holocaust

En español: *Holocausto*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi Germany's systematic genocide of 6 million Jews and millions of others (Roma, disabled, homosexuals, political opponents) during World War II.

Nuremberg Laws (1935)

En español: *Leyes de Nuremberg (1935)*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi racial laws that stripped Jews of German citizenship, banned intermarriage between Jews and non-Jews, and defined "Jewishness" by ancestry. They institutionalized anti-Semitic persecution.

Adolf Hitler

En español: *Adolf Hitler*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi dictator of Germany (1933-1945) who led Germany into World War II and orchestrated the Holocaust, resulting in the deaths of 6 million Jews and millions of others.

Check your understanding

How did U.S. immigration restrictions and public attitudes limit American response to Jewish refugees before WWII?

- A** The U.S. welcomed all Jewish refugees without restriction, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- B** Only economic factors affected refugee policy, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- C** **The National Origins Act quotas, consular obstruction, anti-Semitism, isolationism, and economic fears during the Depression combined to severely limit Jewish immigration** ✓ KEY
- D** The U.S. had no immigration restrictions in the 1930s, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.48

American Entry into World War II

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.01

Collect sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the reasons for American entry into World War II, including the attack on Pearl Harbor.

I CAN

I can explain the reasons for American entry into World War II, including the attack on Pearl Harbor.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.47 What was the Holocaust?

2

US.47 How did Americans confirm the full scale of the Holocaust?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What Japanese attack brought the United States into World War II?

✓ **ANSWER**

The attack on Pearl Harbor, December 7, 1941.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

On the morning of December 7, 1941, Japanese planes struck the U.S. naval base at Pearl Harbor, killing more than 2,400 Americans and sinking or damaging much of the Pacific fleet in under two hours.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Was Pearl Harbor the cause of American entry into World War II, or the spark that lit a fire already waiting to burn?

US.48 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Pearl Harbor

say: *purl HAR-ber*

Pearl Harbor

Japan's surprise attack on the U.S. naval base in Hawaii on December 7, 1941, killing over 2,400 Americans and bringing the United States into World War II.

Hideki Tojo

say: *hee-DEH-kee TOH-joh*

Hideki Tojo

Japanese military leader and Prime Minister (1941-1944) who led Japan into World War II and authorized the attack on Pearl Harbor.

Axis Powers

say: *AK-sis POW-erz*

Potencias del Eje

Military alliance of Germany, Italy, and Japan during World War II. United by shared goals of territorial expansion, militarism, and opposition to democratic nations.

Allied Powers

say: *AL-yd POW-erz*

Potencias Aliadas

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

Lend-Lease Act (1941)

say: *lend lees akt*

*Ley de Préstamo y Arriendo
(1941)*

U.S. program allowing the President to lend or lease war supplies to any nation deemed vital to American defense, primarily Britain and the Soviet Union.

Nazi-Soviet Pact (1939)

say: *NOT-see SOH-vee-et pakt*

Pacto Nazi-Soviético (1939)

Non-aggression agreement between Hitler and Stalin (August 1939) that shocked the world. Secret provisions divided Poland and Eastern Europe between Germany and the Soviet Union.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Factors in the European Theater

- German U-boats attacked U.S. ships carrying Lend-Lease supplies, leading to an undeclared naval war with the U.S. Navy escorting convoys and engaging German submarines.
- The Atlantic Charter created moral and strategic partnership with Britain.
- The Destroyer Deal exchanged U.S. destroyers for British bases, and U.S. forces occupied Iceland to prevent German control.
- These actions increasingly moved America toward war despite isolationist opposition.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The U.S. entered World War II because of _____ in Europe and _____ in the Pacific, but the immediate trigger was _____.

Factors in the Pacific Theater

- Japan conquered much of China and Southeast Asia, threatening U.S. territories and interests.
- In response, the U.S. imposed economic sanctions including an oil embargo and froze Japanese assets (July 1941).
- The Hull Note demanded Japanese withdrawal from China and Indochina, but negotiations failed to resolve differences.
- Japan's military leaders saw war with America as inevitable given the economic pressure.

US.48 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

3 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Attack on Pearl Harbor (December 7, 1941)

- Japan planned to eliminate the U.S. Pacific Fleet to prevent interference with expansion.
- Six aircraft carriers launched 353 planes in two waves on Sunday morning when defenses were relaxed.
- The attack sank or damaged 8 battleships, destroyed 188 planes, and killed 2,403 Americans.
- Intelligence failures left U.S. forces completely unprepared.
- Roosevelt's "Date of Infamy" speech galvanized the nation, and Congress declared war with only one dissenting vote.



Unknown U.S. Navy photographer / U.S. Navy, December 7, 1941
[National Archives](#)

Consequences of American Entry

- Pearl Harbor destroyed isolationist opposition and unified American public opinion.
- Germany and Italy declared war on the U.S. (December 11), making the conflict worldwide.
- Domestically, war ended the Great Depression and created full employment, while the government gained unprecedented powers.
- Internationally, U.S. entry provided resources necessary to defeat the Axis, established America as the dominant world power, and led to the creation of the United Nations.

Key Figure

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President; asked Congress to declare war

- Called Dec 7, 1941 'a date which will live in infamy'
- Secured a declaration of war on Japan within a day
- Led the mobilization of the 'Arsenal of Democracy'

STRATEGY Use FDR's Infamy speech to show how leadership turns a shock into a national war effort.

US.48 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Day of Infamy Speech

Close Reading

President Franklin D. Roosevelt • December 8, 1941

"Yesterday, December 7th, 1941—a date which will live in infamy—the United States of America was suddenly and deliberately attacked by naval and air forces of the Empire of Japan. The United States was at peace with that nation and, at the solicitation of Japan, was still in conversation with its government and its Emperor looking toward the maintenance of peace in the Pacific."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

On December 7, 1941, Japan launched a surprise attack on the U.S. naval base at Pearl Harbor, Hawaii, killing more than 2,400 Americans and destroying or damaging much of the Pacific Fleet. The next day, President Roosevelt addressed Congress to ask for a declaration of war. His speech—delivered in just six minutes—is one of the most famous in American history and helped unite a divided country behind the war effort.

ANALYZE

According to Roosevelt, why was the Japanese attack particularly treacherous?

SOURCE IT FIRST <i>SSR.02 • before you interpret</i>	WHO made it? President Franklin D. Roosevelt	WHEN? December 8, 1941	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	--	----------------------------------	--

Source: [National Archives](#)

Let's Work One Together

Explain causes of a decision

MODEL PROMPT: Why did Pearl Harbor unite Americans behind war?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

A surprise attack on U.S. soil ended the debate over neutrality. FDR's 'infamy' framing turned shock into resolve, and Congress declared war almost unanimously.

THINK ALOUD

Underline the phrase in the speech built to unify the country.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain how one word choice moved public opinion, citing the text.*

US.48 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Two Theaters, One War — Why America Entered

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read FDR's 'Day of Infamy' speech excerpt and review the Pearl Harbor photograph. Build a two-column chart: EUROPEAN THEATER FACTORS (Axis aggression, fall of France, threat to Britain, aid to Allies) and PACIFIC THEATER FACTORS (Japanese expansion, U.S. embargo, the attack on Pearl Harbor). List at least two per column. Then write a one-sentence claim on whether Pearl Harbor caused U.S. entry or simply triggered a decision that was already coming.

DELIVERABLE

Completed two-theater factors chart (2+ per column) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the cause of U.S. entry.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart pre-labeled 'European Theater' and 'Pacific Theater' with a word bank of factors to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using the 'Day of Infamy' speech to explain how FDR united the country behind a declaration of war.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us48-american-entry-wwii.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us48-american-entry-wwii.pdf)

US.48 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did the U.S. policy of neutrality evolve before Pearl Harbor?

- A** From strict isolationism to "Arsenal of Democracy" providing aid to the Allies.
- B** As a sudden, deliberate, and premeditated attack requiring righteous response.
- C** Isolationist organization opposing U.S. entry into WWII before Pearl Harbor.
- D** Unified Americans behind the war effort and ended isolationist sentiment overnight.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the U.S. policy of neutrality evolve before Pearl Harbor?

- A** From strict isolationism to "Arsenal of Democracy" providing aid to the Allies. ✓
- B** As a sudden, deliberate, and premeditated attack requiring righteous response.
- C** Isolationist organization opposing U.S. entry into WWII before Pearl Harbor.
- D** Unified Americans behind the war effort and ended isolationist sentiment overnight.

Correct answer: A. Why: From strict isolationism to "Arsenal of Democracy" providing aid to the Allies. The attack on December 7, 1941 pushed the United States fully into World War II. C is incorrect because it describes a different program, event, or idea than this World War II event. This helps explain how World War II transformed the United States into a global power.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Factors in the European Theater
- Factors in the Pacific Theater
- Attack on Pearl Harbor (December 7, 1941)
- Consequences of American Entry

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did Pearl Harbor cause U.S. entry into WWII, or simply trigger a decision that was already coming? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain the reasons the United States entered World War II. Address both the European and Pacific theaters.

Words you need before we read

Pearl Harbor

En español: *Pearl Harbor*

WHAT IT MEANS

Japan's surprise attack on the U.S. naval base in Hawaii on December 7, 1941, killing over 2,400 Americans and bringing the United States into World War II.

Hideki Tojo

En español: *Hideki Tojo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Japanese military leader and Prime Minister (1941-1944) who led Japan into World War II and authorized the attack on Pearl Harbor.

Axis Powers

En español: *Potencias del Eje*

WHAT IT MEANS

Military alliance of Germany, Italy, and Japan during World War II. United by shared goals of territorial expansion, militarism, and opposition to democratic nations.

Check your understanding

How did the Pearl Harbor attack unite American public opinion and end isolationism?

- A** Public opinion remained divided after Pearl Harbor, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- B** Isolationism continued throughout the war, but the historical record tells a more complex story and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- C** Pearl Harbor had no effect on public opinion, but the historical record tells a more complex story and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- D** The surprise attack shocked Americans, Roosevelt's "Date of Infamy" speech galvanized the nation, and Congress declared war with only one dissenting vote, destroying isolationist opposition ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.49

WWII Leaders & Key Figures

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Identify the roles and the significant actions of the following individuals in World War II: Winston Churchill, Dwight D. Eisenhower, Adolf Hitler, Douglas MacArthur, George C. Marshall, Benito Mussolini, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, Joseph Stalin, Hideki Tojo, President Harry S. Truman.

I CAN

I can identify the roles and the significant actions of key individuals in World War II, including Churchill, Eisenhower, Hitler, MacArthur, Marshall, Mussolini, FDR, Stalin, Tojo, and Truman.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.48 What happened on December 7, 1941?

2

US.48 Why did the U.S. declare war after Pearl Harbor?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Who was the U.S. president for most of World War II?

✓ **ANSWER**

Franklin D. Roosevelt (Harry S. Truman took over in April 1945).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

World War II was shaped by a handful of towering figures, Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin against Hitler, Mussolini, and Tojo, whose decisions sent tens of millions to war and reshaped the world.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How much does history depend on individual leaders, and which of these figures most changed the outcome of the war?

US.49 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Dwight D. Eisenhower

say: dwyt EYE-zen-how-er

Dwight D. Eisenhower

Supreme Commander of Allied Forces in Europe who planned and led the D-Day invasion and coordinated Allied victory in Europe. Later became 34th President.

Adolf Hitler

say: AY-dolf HIT-ler

Adolf Hitler

Nazi dictator of Germany (1933-1945) who led Germany into World War II and orchestrated the Holocaust, resulting in the deaths of 6 million Jews and millions of others.

Joseph Stalin

say: JOH-zef STAH-lin

Joseph Stalin

Communist dictator of the Soviet Union (1924-1953) who ruled through terror, forced collectivization, and purges, resulting in millions of deaths.

Hideki Tojo

say: hee-DEH-kee TOH-joh

Hideki Tojo

Japanese military leader and Prime Minister (1941-1944) who led Japan into World War II and authorized the attack on Pearl Harbor.

Allied Powers

say: AL-yd POW-erz

Potencias Aliadas

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

Axis Powers

say: AK-sis POW-erz

Potencias del Eje

Military alliance of Germany, Italy, and Japan during World War II. United by shared goals of territorial expansion, militarism, and opposition to democratic nations.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

US.49 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

1 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Allied Political Leaders

- Winston Churchill served as British Prime Minister (1940-1945), inspiring British resistance during the Battle of Britain and partnering with FDR on the Atlantic Charter.
- Franklin D. Roosevelt led America as President, implementing Lend-Lease, maintaining the Grand Alliance with Churchill and Stalin, and supporting the "Europe First" strategy.
- Joseph Stalin defended the Soviet Union against German invasion, achieved victory at Stalingrad, and led the massive Soviet advance that captured Berlin.
- Harry S. Truman became President in 1945, making the atomic bomb decision and overseeing Japanese surrender.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

One important Allied leader was _____, who _____, while an Axis leader, _____, _____.

Allied Military Leaders

- Dwight D. Eisenhower served as Supreme Allied Commander in Europe, planning D-Day and successfully managing the multinational Allied command.
- Douglas MacArthur commanded Allied forces in the Southwest Pacific, developing the island-hopping strategy and accepting Japanese surrender aboard USS Missouri.
- George C. Marshall, as Army Chief of Staff, organized the expansion of the U.S. Army from 200,000 to 8 million, developed the "Europe First" strategy, and coordinated global logistics.

Axis Leaders

- Adolf Hitler, as Führer of Nazi Germany, developed blitzkrieg tactics, launched Operation Barbarossa against the Soviet Union, and orchestrated the Holocaust before committing suicide as Berlin fell.
- Benito Mussolini established fascist Italy and formed the Axis alliance, but Italian military failures required German rescue before he was captured and executed by partisans.
- Hideki Tojo, Japanese Prime Minister, authorized the Pearl Harbor attack and led Japan's Pacific conquest before being executed as a war criminal.

Comparing Leadership Approaches

- Churchill provided inspirational leadership through rhetoric and determination.
- Eisenhower excelled at diplomatic coalition management.
- Hitler's dictatorial style led to strategic mistakes like fighting a two-front war.
- MacArthur was dramatic and media-conscious.
- Marshall demonstrated exceptional organizational ability.
- Roosevelt and Churchill maintained a "special relationship" while managing the difficult alliance with Stalin.
- The contrast between Allied cooperation and Axis failures in coordination contributed significantly to the war's outcome.

Key Figures

Winston Churchill

British Prime Minister (1874-1965)

- Rallied Britain to fight on alone in 1940
- Forged the alliance with FDR and Stalin
- Symbolized Allied resolve with his defiant speeches

STRATEGY Use Churchill to represent Allied leadership and the power of wartime rhetoric.

Dwight D. Eisenhower

Supreme Allied Commander, Europe (1890-1969)

- Planned and commanded the D-Day invasion
- Held the multinational Allied force together
- Later became the 34th U.S. president

STRATEGY Use Eisenhower to show the organizational genius behind Allied victory.

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President; commander in chief

- Directed U.S. grand strategy across two theaters
- Kept the Grand Alliance together through tension
- Defined Allied war aims from the Atlantic Charter on

STRATEGY Anchor the Allied leaders around FDR as the coalition's political center.

US.49 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

We Shall Fight on the Beaches Speech

Close Reading

Winston Churchill • June 4, 1940

"We shall fight on the beaches, we shall fight on the landing grounds, we shall fight in the fields and in the streets, we shall fight in the hills; we shall never surrender, and even if, which I do not for a moment believe, this Island or a large part of it were subjugated and starving, then our Empire beyond the seas... would carry on the struggle."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

In June 1940, Nazi Germany had just defeated France and driven British forces off the European continent at Dunkirk. Britain stood almost alone against Hitler's military machine, and many feared German invasion was imminent. Churchill had just become Prime Minister weeks earlier and used this speech to the House of Commons to steel the British people's resolve and signal to America and the world that Britain would not surrender.

ANALYZE

What message was Churchill conveying to the British people in this speech?

SOURCE IT FIRST <i>SSR.02 • before you interpret</i>	WHO made it? Winston Churchill	WHEN? June 4, 1940	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	--	------------------------------	--

Source: [International Churchill Society](#)

Let's Work One Together

Match individuals to their roles

MODEL PROMPT: How did Churchill, Eisenhower, and FDR each shape the Allied effort?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Churchill supplied resolve and rhetoric, Eisenhower supplied military planning, FDR supplied strategy and the alliance. Different roles, one coalition.

THINK ALOUD

Assign each leader a one-word role (resolve / planning / strategy).

→ **Now you try:** *Argue which role mattered most at a turning point, with evidence.*

US.49 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Who Led the World at War — Allied and Axis Leaders

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using Churchill's 'We Shall Fight on the Beaches' excerpt and your notes, build a leaders chart with three columns: ALLIED POLITICAL (FDR, Churchill, Stalin, Truman), ALLIED MILITARY (Eisenhower, MacArthur, Marshall), and AXIS (Hitler, Mussolini, Tojo). For each leader, write one significant action. Finish with a one-sentence claim on which single leader's actions most changed the war's outcome, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed leaders chart (one significant action per leader across the three columns) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the most decisive leader.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with leaders pre-listed and a bank of actions to match. Honors: Write a paragraph using Churchill's speech to explain how wartime leaders used words, not just armies, as weapons.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us49-wwii-leaders.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us49-wwii-leaders.pdf)

US.49 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did the roles of General Dwight D. Eisenhower and General Douglas MacArthur differ in World War II?

- A** Eisenhower served as Supreme Allied Commander in Europe while MacArthur commanded Allied forces in the Pacific.
- B** Eisenhower commanded Pacific island-hopping campaigns while MacArthur directed the D-Day landings in Europe.
- C** Eisenhower focused on the naval war in the Atlantic while MacArthur managed the bombing campaign over Japan.
- D** Both generals shared command of European theater operations, with Eisenhower directing ground forces and MacArthur directing air forces.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the roles of General Dwight D. Eisenhower and General Douglas MacArthur differ in World War II?

- A** Eisenhower served as Supreme Allied Commander in Europe while MacArthur commanded Allied forces in the Pacific. ✓
- B** Eisenhower commanded Pacific island-hopping campaigns while MacArthur directed the D-Day landings in Europe.
- C** Eisenhower focused on the naval war in the Atlantic while MacArthur managed the bombing campaign over Japan.
- D** Both generals shared command of European theater operations, with Eisenhower directing ground forces and MacArthur directing air forces.

Correct answer: A. Why: Eisenhower served as Supreme Commander of Allied Expeditionary Forces in Europe, overseeing operations including D-Day, while MacArthur commanded Allied forces in the Southwest Pacific, directing the island-hopping campaign and eventually accepting Japan's surrender.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Allied Political Leaders
- Allied Military Leaders
- Axis Leaders
- Comparing Leadership Approaches

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: Which single leader's actions most changed the outcome of World War II?
Defend your choice with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Identify two key WWII leaders (one Allied, one Axis) and explain one significant action of each.

Words you need before we read

Dwight D. Eisenhower

En español: *Dwight D. Eisenhower*

WHAT IT MEANS

Supreme Commander of Allied Forces in Europe who planned and led the D-Day invasion and coordinated Allied victory in Europe. Later became 34th President.

Adolf Hitler

En español: *Adolf Hitler*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nazi dictator of Germany (1933-1945) who led Germany into World War II and orchestrated the Holocaust, resulting in the deaths of 6 million Jews and millions of others.

Joseph Stalin

En español: *Joseph Stalin*

WHAT IT MEANS

Communist dictator of the Soviet Union (1924-1953) who ruled through terror, forced collectivization, and purges, resulting in millions of deaths.

Check your understanding

How did Allied leaders like Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin coordinate their war efforts despite different goals?

A Through conferences at Tehran and Yalta, the "Europe First" strategy, and division of responsibilities, they maintained cooperation despite tensions over post-war Europe and different ideological systems

✓ KEY

B They never coordinated their efforts, which does not align with the documented historical record and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

C Stalin made all decisions for the alliance, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved

D They fought completely separate wars, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.50

Major WWII Battles: Midway, Iwo Jima, Okinawa & D-Day

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the role of geographic and military factors on the outcomes of battles in the Pacific and European theaters of war, including the Battles of Midway, Iwo Jima, Okinawa, and D-Day.

I CAN

I can explain the role of geographic and military factors on the outcomes of battles in the Pacific and European theaters, including Midway, Iwo Jima, Okinawa, and D-Day.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.49 Name one Allied leader and one Axis leader.

2

US.49 Who was the Supreme Allied Commander for the D-Day invasion?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was the June 6, 1944 Allied invasion of France called?

✓ **ANSWER**

D-Day, the Normandy invasion.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

From a tiny Pacific atoll called Midway to the storm-tossed beaches of Normandy, the outcome of World War II turned on a few decisive battles where geography, timing, and courage decided the fate of nations.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did geography and military strategy turn the tide of World War II in both the Pacific and Europe?

US.50 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

D-Day (Normandy Invasion)

Día D (Invasión de Normandía)

say: dee-day NOR-mun-dee

June 6, 1944 Allied invasion of Nazi-occupied France across the beaches of Normandy, the largest amphibious assault in history, turning point of the war in Europe.

Battle of Midway

Batalla de Midway

say: BAT-ul uv MID-way

June 1942 decisive U.S. naval victory that stopped Japanese expansion in the Pacific and marked the turning point of the Pacific War.

Battle of Iwo Jima

Batalla de Iwo Jima

say: BAT-ul uv EE-woh JEE-muh

February-March 1945 brutal battle for a strategic Pacific island, famous for the iconic flag-raising photograph on Mount Suribachi.

Battle of the Bulge

Batalla de las Ardenas

say: BAT-ul uv thuh bulj

Germany's last major offensive (December 1944-January 1945) in the Ardennes forest, creating a "bulge" in Allied lines before being defeated.

Dwight D. Eisenhower

Dwight D. Eisenhower

say: dwyt EYE-zen-how-er

Supreme Commander of Allied Forces in Europe who planned and led the D-Day invasion and coordinated Allied victory in Europe. Later became 34th President.

Allied Powers

Potencias Aliadas

say: AL-yd POW-erz

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Battle of Midway (June 1942)

- Midway Atoll's strategic location in the central Pacific made it crucial for both Japanese expansion and American defense.
- U.S. codebreakers broke Japanese naval codes, revealing attack plans.
- American carriers ambushed the Japanese fleet, sinking four aircraft carriers and destroying Japan's offensive capability.
- This "Miracle at Midway" shifted the Pacific war's momentum permanently to the Allies, demonstrating the critical importance of intelligence in modern warfare.

SENTENCE FRAME *(EL & writing support)*

The Battle of _____ mattered because _____, showing how geography shaped the war.

Battle of Iwo Jima (February-March 1945)

- Iwo Jima's volcanic terrain created natural fortifications that Japanese defenders exploited through an extensive tunnel system.
- The island's airfields were needed for emergency landings by B-29 bombers attacking Japan and for fighter escorts.
- Despite knowing the location of Japanese defenses, Marines suffered nearly 7,000 killed and 20,000 wounded in 36 days of fighting.
- The iconic flag raising on Mount Suribachi became a symbol of American determination.



Joe Rosenthal / Associated Press (remade from NARA File 520748), February 23, 1945 [National Archives](#)

Battle of Okinawa (April-June 1945)

- Okinawa's proximity to Japan (340 miles) made it essential as a staging base for invasion.
- The 82-day battle was the bloodiest Pacific campaign, with over 12,000 Americans killed and 110,000 Japanese military deaths.
- Mass kamikaze attacks damaged or sank hundreds of ships.
- The horrific casualties influenced American decisions about invading Japan versus using atomic weapons, as projected invasion casualties ran into the hundreds of thousands.

D-Day: Normandy Invasion (June 6, 1944)

- The Normandy coast was chosen for its beaches suitable for landing craft, proximity to English ports, and weaker defenses than Pas-de-Calais.
- Allied deception operations convinced Germans the main attack would come elsewhere.
- Despite heavy casualties at Omaha Beach, Allied forces established beachheads and broke through German defenses.
- The largest amphibious invasion in history required unprecedented coordination of land, sea, and air forces, opening the Western Front that would ultimately liberate Western Europe.



Chief Photographer's Mate Robert F. Sargent / U.S. Coast Guard, June 6, 1944 [National Archives](#)

Key Figure

Gen. Dwight D. Eisenhower

Commander of D-Day (1890-1969)

- Chose June 6, 1944 despite risky weather
- Coordinated air, sea, and land forces at Normandy
- Opened the Western front that doomed Nazi Germany

STRATEGY Tie Eisenhower's decisions to the geographic and logistical factors driving each battle.

US.50 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Order of the Day - D-Day

Contextualization

General Dwight D. Eisenhower • June 6, 1944

"Soldiers, Sailors, and Airmen of the Allied Expeditionary Force! You are about to embark upon the Great Crusade, toward which we have striven these many months. The eyes of the world are upon you. The hope and prayers of liberty-loving people everywhere march with you... The tide has turned! The free men of the world are marching together to Victory!"

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

By June 1944, the Allies had been fighting Nazi Germany for nearly five years. The D-Day invasion of Normandy, France was the largest amphibious military operation in history, involving nearly 160,000 Allied troops crossing the English Channel to open a western front against Hitler. General Eisenhower issued this order to boost morale and convey the historic significance of what soldiers were about to attempt.

ANALYZE

How does Eisenhower describe the significance of the D-Day invasion?

SOURCE IT FIRST <i>SSR.02 • before you interpret</i>	WHO made it? General Dwight D. Eisenhower	WHEN? June 6, 1944	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	---	------------------------------	--

Source: [National Archives](#)

Let's Work One Together

Link geography to military outcome

MODEL PROMPT: Why did geography decide the outcome at Normandy and Midway?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

At Normandy, beaches, tides, and surprise shaped the landing; at Midway, distance and carrier range decided the battle. Terrain and logistics, not just courage, drove results.

THINK ALOUD

Circle one geographic factor named in the source.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain how that factor changed the battle's outcome, citing the text.*

US.50 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Terrain and Turning Points — Geography of the Great Battles

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Eisenhower's D-Day 'Order of the Day' and review the Normandy photograph. For four battles, Midway, Iwo Jima, Okinawa, and D-Day, record the theater (Pacific or European), one geographic or military factor that shaped the outcome, and the result. Finish with a one-sentence claim on how geography decided one of these battles, supported by evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-battle chart (theater, geographic/military factor, result)
AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about geography's role.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the four battles pre-labeled and a word bank of factors and results to place. Honors: Write a paragraph using Eisenhower's order to explain the enormous risk and planning behind the D-Day invasion.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us50-major-wwii-battles.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us50-major-wwii-battles.pdf)

US.50 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

Why was the Battle of Midway considered a turning point in the Pacific theater of World War II?

- A** Because American forces captured the Japanese home island of Kyushu, threatening Tokyo directly.
- B** Because the U.S. destroyed four Japanese aircraft carriers, permanently crippling Japan's offensive naval power.
- C** Because the battle ended Japan's alliance with Germany, allowing the U.S. to focus all resources on Europe.
- D** Because American forces first used the atomic bomb in the battle, forcing Japan to negotiate a ceasefire.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

Why was the Battle of Midway considered a turning point in the Pacific theater of World War II?

- A** Because American forces captured the Japanese home island of Kyushu, threatening Tokyo directly.
- B** Because the U.S. destroyed four Japanese aircraft carriers, permanently crippling Japan's offensive naval power. ✓
- C** Because the battle ended Japan's alliance with Germany, allowing the U.S. to focus all resources on Europe.
- D** Because American forces first used the atomic bomb in the battle, forcing Japan to negotiate a ceasefire.

Correct answer: B. Why: At Midway, U.S. naval intelligence cracked Japanese codes, enabling American carrier aircraft to surprise and sink four Japanese fleet carriers — the core of Japan's offensive capacity. This irreplaceable loss shifted the strategic initiative in the Pacific to the United States.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Battle of Midway (June 1942)
- Battle of Iwo Jima (February-March 1945)
- Battle of Okinawa (April-June 1945)
- D-Day: Normandy Invasion (June 6, 1944)

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: In WWII, did geography or leadership matter more in deciding battles?
Argue your position with evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how geographic and military factors shaped the outcome of two major WWII battles.

Words you need before we read

D-Day (Normandy Invasion)

En español: *Día D (Invasión de Normandía)*

WHAT IT MEANS

June 6, 1944 Allied invasion of Nazi-occupied France across the beaches of Normandy, the largest amphibious assault in history, turning point of the war in Europe.

Battle of Midway

En español: *Batalla de Midway*

WHAT IT MEANS

June 1942 decisive U.S. naval victory that stopped Japanese expansion in the Pacific and marked the turning point of the Pacific War.

Battle of Iwo Jima

En español: *Batalla de Iwo Jima*

WHAT IT MEANS

February-March 1945 brutal battle for a strategic Pacific island, famous for the iconic flag-raising photograph on Mount Suribachi.

Check your understanding

How did geographic features of the Pacific islands affect American military strategy in battles like Midway and Iwo Jima?

- A** Geography had no effect on Pacific strategy, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- B** Midway's central location made it strategically vital, while Iwo Jima's volcanic terrain created natural fortifications requiring costly direct assault to secure airfields needed for bombing Japan ✓ KEY
- C** All Pacific islands were geographically identical, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D** American forces avoided geographic challenges entirely, which does not align with the documented historical record, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.51

Special Fighting Forces in WWII

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.04

Build an argument

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Identify the roles and sacrifices of individual American soldiers, as well as the unique contributions of special fighting forces such as the Tuskegee Airmen, the 442nd Regimental Combat team, the 101st Airborne, and the Navajo Code Talkers.

I CAN

I can identify the roles and sacrifices of individual American soldiers and the unique contributions of special fighting forces such as the Tuskegee Airmen, the 442nd Regimental Combat Team, the 101st Airborne, and the Navajo Code Talkers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.50 Why was the Battle of Midway (1942) a turning point?

2

US.50 What was D-Day?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Name one special fighting force made up of a minority group in WWII.

✓ **ANSWER**

The Tuskegee Airmen, the 442nd Regimental Combat Team, or the Navajo Code Talkers.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

They fought two wars at once, one against the Axis abroad and one against prejudice at home: the Tuskegee Airmen, the Japanese American 442nd, the paratroopers of the 101st Airborne, and the Navajo Code Talkers whose language the enemy never broke.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why would Americans risk their lives for a country that did not yet grant them equal rights, and what did their service prove?

US.51 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Tuskegee Airmen

say: tus-KEE-gee AIR-men

Aviadores de Tuskegee

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

442nd Regimental Combat Team

say: for-for-tee-SEK-und rej-ih-MEN-tul

*442º Equipo de Combate
Regimental*

All Japanese-American unit that became the most decorated unit in U.S. military history, fighting in Europe while their families were interned at home.

Navajo Code Talkers

say: NAV-uh-hoh kohd TAWK-erz

*Descifradores de Código
Navajo*

Navajo Marines who used their native language to create an unbreakable code for military communications in the Pacific theater.

Battle of Iwo Jima

say: BAT-ul uv EE-woh JEE-muh

Batalla de Iwo Jima

February-March 1945 brutal battle for a strategic Pacific island, famous for the iconic flag-raising photograph on Mount Suribachi.

Allied Powers

say: AL-yd POW-erz

Potencias Aliadas

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

Holocaust

say: HOL-uh-kawst

Holocausto

Nazi Germany's systematic genocide of 6 million Jews and millions of others (Roma, disabled, homosexuals, political opponents) during World War II.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

US.51 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

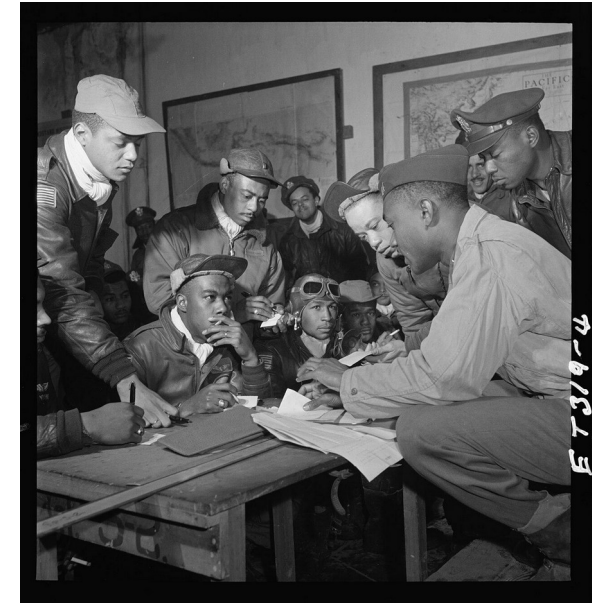
1 of 5 ● ● ● ● ●

Tuskegee Airmen

- The Tuskegee Airmen were the first African American military aviators in the U.S. Armed Forces.
- Trained at Tuskegee Army Air Field in Alabama, the 332nd Fighter Group flew over 15,000 sorties in Europe and North Africa.
- They earned over 150 Distinguished Flying Crosses and a Presidential Unit Citation.
- Despite facing racism and segregation within the military, they compiled an outstanding combat record, helping to pave the way for the desegregation of the armed forces in 1948.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The _____ contributed to the war by _____, even though they faced _____ at home.



Toni Frissell / Library of Congress, Toni Frissell Collection, March 1945
[Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

442nd Regimental Combat Team

- The 442nd was composed almost entirely of Japanese American volunteers, many of whose families were confined in internment camps.
- Fighting in Europe, they became the most decorated unit of their size in U.S. military history, earning over 18,000 individual decorations including 21 Medals of Honor.
- Their motto "Go for Broke" reflected their determination to prove their loyalty to America despite the government's unjust treatment of their families.

US.51 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

3 of 5 ● ● ● ● ●

101st Airborne Division

- The "Screaming Eagles" of the 101st Airborne Division parachuted into Normandy on D-Day, June 6, 1944, securing key bridges and crossroads behind enemy lines to support the beach landings.
- They later defended Bastogne during the Battle of the Bulge, where Acting Commander General Anthony McAuliffe famously replied "Nuts!" to a German surrender demand.
- Their elite training and courage under fire made them one of the most celebrated units in American military history.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

The 101st Airborne Division, the 'Screaming Eagles,' has deep Tennessee ties: the division is headquartered at Fort Campbell on the Tennessee-Kentucky border. In WWII its paratroopers dropped behind enemy lines on D-Day to secure bridges and crossroads and later held the line at Bastogne during the Battle of the Bulge.

Navajo Code Talkers

- Navajo Marines developed an unbreakable military code based on their native language, which had no written form and was virtually unknown outside the Navajo Nation.
- Code Talkers served in every major Marine operation in the Pacific from 1942-1945, transmitting battlefield communications that the Japanese never deciphered.
- Their contributions were so vital that commanders credited them with the success at Iwo Jima.
- Their service remained classified until 1968 and was formally recognized with Congressional Gold Medals in 2001.

Individual Sacrifice and Legacy

- These special fighting forces demonstrated extraordinary courage while often fighting two wars—one against foreign enemies and another against discrimination at home.
- Their sacrifices challenged racial prejudices, proved that patriotism transcended race and ethnicity, and contributed to post-war civil rights advances.
- Veterans of these units became leaders in their communities and advocates for equality, using their military records to demand the rights they had fought to defend.

Key Figures

The Tuskegee Airmen

First Black U.S. military pilots

- Flew hundreds of bomber-escort missions in Europe
- Earned an outstanding combat record despite segregation
- Proved the case against a segregated military

STRATEGY Use the Airmen to connect battlefield sacrifice to the fight for civil rights at home.

The 442nd Regimental Combat Team

Japanese American Army unit

- Became the most decorated unit of its size in U.S. history
- Fought in Italy and France while families sat in camps
- Embodied 'Go for Broke' loyalty under injustice

STRATEGY Pair the 442nd with internment (US.54) so students hold sacrifice and injustice together.

The Navajo Code Talkers

Marine communications specialists

- Turned the Navajo language into an unbreakable code
- Transmitted vital orders in Pacific battles
- Gave the U.S. a decisive communications edge

STRATEGY Use the Code Talkers to show how diverse Americans made unique, decisive contributions.

US.51 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Tuskegee Airmen Commendation

Corroboration

U.S. Army Air Forces • 1945

"The 332nd Fighter Group has established an outstanding record by continuously outstanding performance of duty... Your formation has not lost a single bomber to enemy fighters. The determination, technique, and courage shown by your group in engaging enemy aircraft has been outstanding."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

The Tuskegee Airmen were the first African American military aviators in the U.S. armed forces, trained at Tuskegee Army Air Field in Alabama during World War II. They served in a racially segregated military that many believed African Americans were unfit to be combat pilots. Their outstanding record as escort fighters—protecting bombers on missions over Europe—helped challenge racial stereotypes and laid the groundwork for military desegregation.

ANALYZE

What evidence does this document provide about the Tuskegee Airmen's military effectiveness?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSP.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

U.S. Army Air Forces

WHEN?

1945

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Let's Work One Together

Evaluate contributions under
injustice

MODEL PROMPT: What made the Tuskegee Airmen's record so significant?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

They fought and excelled while serving in a segregated military. Their record was evidence, not just valor - it refuted the claim that Black pilots couldn't perform.

THINK ALOUD

Find the sentence naming their combat achievement.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain how their service became an argument for change at home.*

US.51 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Fighting Two Wars — Special Forces and Individual Sacrifice

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Tuskegee Airmen commendation and study the photograph. Build a chart for four special forces, the Tuskegee Airmen, the 442nd Regimental Combat Team, the 101st Airborne, and the Navajo Code Talkers, recording their unique contribution and one obstacle or sacrifice each faced. Finish with a one-sentence claim on how these groups fought discrimination at home while fighting the enemy abroad, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-unit chart (contribution + obstacle/sacrifice each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the 'two wars' these soldiers fought.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the four units pre-labeled and a fact bank of contributions to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using the Tuskegee Airmen commendation to argue how their record challenged racist assumptions of the era.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us51-special-fighting-forces.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us51-special-fighting-forces.pdf)

US.51 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What role did Navajo Code Talkers play in WWII?

- A** Served as translators helping communicate with Japanese prisoners of war in camps.
- B** Used Navajo language to create unbreakable military codes in the Pacific theater.
- C** Fought exclusively in the European theater as specialized infantry scout units.
- D** Worked as intelligence analysts decoding Japanese military radio transmissions at bases.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What role did Navajo Code Talkers play in WWII?

- A** Served as translators helping communicate with Japanese prisoners of war in camps.
- B** Used Navajo language to create unbreakable military codes in the Pacific theater. ✓
- C** Fought exclusively in the European theater as specialized infantry scout units.
- D** Worked as intelligence analysts decoding Japanese military radio transmissions at bases.

Correct answer: B. Why: Used Navajo language to create unbreakable military codes in the Pacific theater. D is incorrect because it describes a different program, event, or idea than the topic in the question. It connects wartime change to the longer struggle for civil rights and equal treatment.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Tuskegee Airmen
- 442nd Regimental Combat Team
- 101st Airborne Division
- Navajo Code Talkers
- Individual Sacrifice and Legacy

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 • SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: What did the service of these units prove about the injustice of discrimination at home? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe the contributions of two special fighting forces in WWII and one obstacle they overcame.

Words you need before we read

Tuskegee Airmen

En español: *Aviadores de Tuskegee*

WHAT IT MEANS

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

442nd Regimental Combat Team

En español: *442º Equipo de Combate Regimental*

WHAT IT MEANS

All Japanese-American unit that became the most decorated unit in U.S. military history, fighting in Europe while their families were interned at home.

Navajo Code Talkers

En español: *Descifradores de Código Navajo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Navajo Marines who used their native language to create an unbreakable code for military communications in the Pacific theater.

Check your understanding

Why is the service of the 442nd Regimental Combat Team particularly significant given the internment of Japanese Americans?

- A** Their service had no connection to internment policies, but the historical record tells a more complex story, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- B** The 442nd was composed of non-Japanese American soldiers, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C** **Japanese American soldiers volunteered to fight for a country that imprisoned their families, becoming the most decorated unit of their size while proving their loyalty despite profound injustice** ✓ KEY
- D** They served only in the Pacific theater, but this fails to account for the broader historical context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.52

Women in World War II

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Examine and explain the entry of large numbers of women into the workforce and armed forces during World War II and the subsequent impact on American society.

I CAN

I can examine and explain the entry of large numbers of women into the workforce and armed forces during World War II and the subsequent impact on American society.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.51 Who were the Tuskegee Airmen?

2

US.51 What did the Navajo Code Talkers do?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What nickname symbolized women who took factory jobs during WWII?

✓ **ANSWER**

Rosie the Riveter.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

As millions of men shipped out to war, American women poured into shipyards and aircraft plants, riveting bombers and welding warships, while others joined the armed forces, changing forever the idea of what women could do.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Did World War II permanently transform women's place in American society, or was 'Rosie the Riveter' only welcome until the men came home?

US.52 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Rosie the Riveter

say: ROH-zee thuh RIV-eh-ter

Rosie la Remachadora

Cultural icon representing millions of American women who worked in factories and shipyards during World War II, filling jobs left by men who went to war.

Tuskegee Airmen

say: tus-KEE-gee AIR-men

Aviadores de Tuskegee

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

Rationing

say: RASH-un-ing

Racionamiento

Government-controlled limits on consumer goods during WWII to ensure adequate supplies for the military, requiring ration books and coupons.

War Bonds

say: wor bondz

Bonos de Guerra

Government bonds sold to citizens to finance the war effort, promoted through massive publicity campaigns featuring celebrities and patriotic appeals.

Allied Powers

say: AL-yd POW-erz

Potencias Aliadas

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

442nd Regimental Combat Team

say: for-for-tee-SEK-und rej-ih-MEN-tul

*442º Equipo de Combate
Regimental*

All Japanese-American unit that became the most decorated unit in U.S. military history, fighting in Europe while their families were interned at home.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Factors Leading to Women's Participation

- With 16 million men serving in the armed forces, a massive labor shortage emerged as war production required doubling the manufacturing workforce.
- Government campaigns like "Rosie the Riveter" recruited women, while economic necessity pushed many families to rely on women's income.
- Women in the workforce grew from 12 million (1940) to 20 million (1945), comprising 36% of the civilian workforce.
- Women made up 65% of aircraft industry workers by war's end.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Women entered the workforce during WWII because _____, and one lasting effect was _____.

Challenges and Opportunities

- Women faced discrimination including lower pay (about 65% of men's wages), dangerous conditions, long hours, and inadequate facilities.
- Social challenges included limited childcare, expectations to maintain domestic duties, and criticism for abandoning traditional roles.
- However, women gained economic independence, learned technical skills, some achieved supervisory positions, and military service provided professional training in communications, mechanics, and aviation.

US.52 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

3 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Impact on Production and Economy

- Women built bombers, fighters, and transport planes; constructed Liberty ships; manufactured ammunition and explosives; and assembled radios and radar equipment.
- Women's entry helped achieve record production levels—296,000 aircraft, 86,000 tanks, 2.3 million trucks.
- This contribution was essential to Allied victory, demonstrating women's capabilities in technical and leadership roles previously reserved for men.



Alfred T. Palmer / U.S. OWI (OWI) / FSA, February 1943 [Library of Congress](#)

Long-term Effects on Society

- After the war, many women were laid off to make room for returning veterans, and social pressure emphasized homemaking and motherhood.
- However, women's labor force participation never returned to pre-war levels.
- The experience provided foundation for the women's rights movement of the 1960s-70s, established precedents for equal employment opportunities, and created pathways for women in previously male professions.
- Military services became permanent parts of armed forces.

Key Figure

Rosie the Riveter

Symbol of women war workers

- Represented millions of women in defense plants
- Filled skilled industrial jobs once closed to women
- Reshaped ideas about what women could do

STRATEGY Use Rosie as an entry point, then move to the real women (like the Nashville plant workers) behind the icon.

US.52 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

War Production Board Poster Text

Close Reading

U.S. War Production Board • 1943

"Do the job HE left behind. Women workers are needed in aircraft plants, shipyards, and munitions factories. Apply at your nearest U.S. Employment Service office. Every woman who takes a war job brings Victory closer. The more women at work—the sooner we win!"

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

When millions of American men went to war after Pearl Harbor, the industrial workforce had a massive labor shortage. The War Production Board recruited women to fill factory jobs in defense industries, producing ships, aircraft, tanks, and ammunition. This wartime mobilization fundamentally shifted gender roles in America—by 1944, nearly 20 million women were working, many for the first time in industrial jobs.

ANALYZE

What argument does this poster make to encourage women to work?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSP.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

U.S. War Production Board

WHEN?

1943

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Let's Work One Together

Analyze wartime social change

MODEL PROMPT: How did the war change women's place in the workforce?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Labor shortages opened skilled defense jobs to millions of women. Propaganda like Rosie recruited them; the experience reshaped expectations even after the war.

THINK ALOUD

Underline one job or industry women entered.

→ **Now you try:** *Predict one lasting effect of this change and support it with the text.*

US.52 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Rosie Goes to Work — Women and the War Effort

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Study the Vultee-Nashville 'Rosie' photograph and the War Production Board poster. Complete a three-part organizer: (1) WHY women entered the workforce and armed forces in large numbers; (2) the CHALLENGES and OPPORTUNITIES they faced; (3) the LONG-TERM EFFECTS on American society. Add two items per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether wartime work permanently changed women's place in society.

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-part organizer (why / challenges-opportunities / long-term effects, 2+ each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about lasting change.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the three sections pre-labeled and a word bank of details to place. Honors: Write a paragraph using the 'Rosie' photograph to analyze how wartime propaganda both empowered and limited women workers.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us52-women-in-wwii.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us52-women-in-wwii.pdf)

US.52 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did women's large-scale entry into the workforce during World War II challenge traditional social expectations in the United States?

- A** It permanently ended the expectation that women would return to domestic roles after the war.
- B** It caused Congress to immediately pass equal pay legislation to ensure women earned the same wages as men.
- C** It led the military to commission women as officers with full command authority over male soldiers.
- D** It demonstrated that women could perform industrial and technical jobs previously considered exclusively male, challenging gender-based occupational limits.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did women's large-scale entry into the workforce during World War II challenge traditional social expectations in the United States?

- A** It permanently ended the expectation that women would return to domestic roles after the war.
- B** It caused Congress to immediately pass equal pay legislation to ensure women earned the same wages as men.
- C** It led the military to commission women as officers with full command authority over male soldiers.
- D** It demonstrated that women could perform industrial and technical jobs previously considered exclusively male, challenging gender-based occupational limits. ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: Wartime labor needs brought millions of women — symbolized by 'Rosie the Riveter' — into factories, shipyards, and offices doing work previously deemed unsuitable for women, proving their competence in industrial roles and planting seeds for later challenges to gender-based employment barriers.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Factors Leading to Women's Participation
- Challenges and Opportunities
- Impact on Production and Economy
- Long-term Effects on Society

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did WWII permanently change women's place in American society, or only temporarily? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain why large numbers of women entered the workforce during WWII and one lasting effect.

Words you need before we read

Rosie the Riveter

En español: *Rosie la Remachadora*

WHAT IT MEANS

Cultural icon representing millions of American women who worked in factories and shipyards during World War II, filling jobs left by men who went to war.

Tuskegee Airmen

En español: *Aviadores de Tuskegee*

WHAT IT MEANS

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

Rationing

En español: *Racionamiento*

WHAT IT MEANS

Government-controlled limits on consumer goods during WWII to ensure adequate supplies for the military, requiring ration books and coupons.

Check your understanding

How did "Rosie the Riveter" symbolize both opportunities and challenges facing working women?

- A** Rosie only represented challenges women faced, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which does not align with the documented historical record
- B** Rosie represented only wealthy women, which does not reflect the consensus among historians despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C** The symbol had no cultural significance, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D** Rosie symbolized women's capability and patriotic duty while obscuring challenges like lower pay, discrimination, inadequate childcare, and expectations to maintain domestic responsibilities ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.53

African Americans in WWII

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Examine the impact of World War II on economic and social conditions for African Americans, including the Fair Employment Practices Committee and the eventual integration of the armed forces by President Harry S. Truman. (TCA)

I CAN

I can examine the impact of World War II on economic and social conditions for African Americans, including the Fair Employment Practices Committee and the eventual integration of the armed forces by President Truman.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.52 What does 'Rosie the Riveter' represent?

2

US.52 Name one long-term effect of women's WWII work.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What order banned racial discrimination in WWII defense industries?

✓ **ANSWER**

Executive Order 8802.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

African Americans left the South by the millions for wartime factory jobs, launched a 'Double V' campaign for victory abroad and at home, and by 1948 had won a presidential order integrating the armed forces.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did fighting a war against Nazi racism abroad push African Americans, and the nation, toward confronting racism at home?

US.53 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Executive Order 8802

say: eg-ZEK-yuh-tiv OR-der

Orden Ejecutiva 8802

The June 1941 order signed by President Roosevelt banning racial discrimination in the defense industry and creating the Fair Employment Practices Committee.

Double V Campaign

say: DUB-ul vee kam-PAYN

Campaña de la Doble V

A World War II campaign led by the Black press calling for a 'Double Victory' - over fascism abroad and racial discrimination at home.

Tuskegee Airmen

say: tus-KEE-gee AIR-men

Aviadores de Tuskegee

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

Rosie the Riveter

say: ROH-zee thuh RIV-eh-ter

Rosie la Remachadora

Cultural icon representing millions of American women who worked in factories and shipyards during World War II, filling jobs left by men who went to war.

Rationing

say: RASH-un-ing

Racionamiento

Government-controlled limits on consumer goods during WWII to ensure adequate supplies for the military, requiring ration books and coupons.

War Bonds

say: wor bondz

Bonos de Guerra

Government bonds sold to citizens to finance the war effort, promoted through massive publicity campaigns featuring celebrities and patriotic appeals.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

US.53 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

1 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Second Great Migration and Economic Opportunities

- 1.5 million African Americans moved North and West during the 1940s to cities like Detroit, Chicago, and Los Angeles.
- Defense industries offered higher wages than Southern agriculture, and average Black family income doubled during the war.
- However, discrimination persisted—many employers refused to hire African Americans, job segregation confined Black workers to lowest-paying positions, and limited advancement opportunities existed.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

World War II changed conditions for African Americans by _____, for example _____.



Unknown / U.S. Army Signal Corps / OWI, c. 1942 [National Archives](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Double V Campaign and Wartime Experiences

- The Pittsburgh Courier promoted the "Double V" campaign—victory against fascism abroad and racism at home.
- One million African Americans served in segregated armed forces, facing prejudice and unequal treatment even while fighting for democracy.
- NAACP membership grew from 50,000 to 450,000 during the war.
- War rhetoric about democracy and freedom raised consciousness about civil rights contradictions in American society.

Fair Employment Practices Committee (FEPC)

- A. Philip Randolph threatened a 100,000-person march on Washington, pressuring FDR to issue Executive Order 8802 (June 25, 1941) creating the FEPC.
- The committee investigated discrimination complaints from defense workers and held public hearings exposing discriminatory practices.
- Though it could only make recommendations without enforcement power, the FEPC established the principle of federal intervention in employment discrimination and laid groundwork for later civil rights agencies.

Integration of Armed Forces

- Executive Order 9981 (1948) by President Truman ordered desegregation of the armed forces, citing merit and fairness.
- Implementation was gradual but historic, representing the first major federal civil rights action of the post-war era.
- The order built on WWII service records of units like the Tuskegee Airmen and 761st Tank Battalion, which had proven African American military capability.
- Military integration became a model for later civilian desegregation efforts.

Key Figures

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President; issued EO 8802

- Signed Executive Order 8802 (1941) banning defense-job discrimination
- Created the Fair Employment Practices Committee
- Acted under pressure from the threatened March on Washington

STRATEGY Use EO 8802 to show wartime pressure producing the first federal fair-employment action.

James G. Thompson / 'Double V'

Voice of the Double V Campaign

- Called for victory over fascism abroad AND racism at home
- His letter launched the Pittsburgh Courier's Double V drive
- Framed Black service as a claim on full citizenship

STRATEGY Use Double V to connect wartime service directly to postwar civil-rights arguments.

US.53 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Executive Order 8802

Close Reading

President Franklin D. Roosevelt • June 25, 1941

"There shall be no discrimination in the employment of workers in defense industries or Government because of race, creed, color, or national origin... It is the duty of employers and of labor organizations... to provide for the full and equitable participation of all workers in defense industries."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Before World War II, African Americans were systematically excluded from many defense industry jobs due to racial discrimination. Civil rights leader A. Philip Randolph threatened to organize a march of 100,000 Black Americans on Washington unless the government acted. Faced with this pressure, Roosevelt issued Executive Order 8802 in June 1941—the first federal action since Reconstruction to promote racial equality in employment.

ANALYZE

What was the purpose of Executive Order 8802?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSP.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

President Franklin D. Roosevelt

WHEN?

June 25, 1941

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Let's Work One Together

Connect service to civil-rights claims

MODEL PROMPT: How did 'Double V' link the war to the fight for equality?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Black Americans demanded victory over fascism abroad AND racism at home. EO 8802 and wartime service became evidence in a larger argument for citizenship.

THINK ALOUD

Identify the two 'victories' the campaign demanded.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain how wartime service strengthened postwar civil-rights arguments.*

US.53 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

The Double V — African Americans in WWII

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Executive Order 8802 and study the integrated-workers photograph. Build a chart tracking four developments: the Second Great Migration and new jobs, the Double V campaign, the Fair Employment Practices Committee (FEPC), and Truman's integration of the armed forces. Write one sentence on the significance of each. Finish with a one-sentence claim on how WWII advanced the later civil rights movement, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-development chart (one-sentence significance each)
AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim linking WWII to civil rights.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the four developments pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort.
Honors: Write a paragraph using Executive Order 8802 to explain what the 'Double V' (victory abroad and at home) meant to Black Americans.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us53-african-americans-wwii.pdf](https://www.troopstoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us53-african-americans-wwii.pdf)

US.53 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did the Double V campaign connect the war abroad to civil rights at home?

- A** It linked victory over fascism overseas with demands for racial equality in the United States.
- B** Working full-time in factories while still managing household and childcare responsibilities.
- C** Many were pressured to leave jobs for returning servicemen, facing social pressure to return home.
- D** Entered workforce in record numbers, gained independence, and challenged gender roles.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the Double V campaign connect the war abroad to civil rights at home?

- A** It linked victory over fascism overseas with demands for racial equality in the United States. ✓
- B** Working full-time in factories while still managing household and childcare responsibilities.
- C** Many were pressured to leave jobs for returning servicemen, facing social pressure to return home.
- D** Entered workforce in record numbers, gained independence, and challenged gender roles.

Correct answer: A. Why: It linked victory over fascism overseas with demands for racial equality in the United States. African Americans linked victory over fascism abroad with the struggle against segregation at home. C is incorrect because it describes a different program, event, or idea than this civil rights question.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Second Great Migration and Economic Opportunities
- Double V Campaign and Wartime Experiences
- Fair Employment Practices Committee (FEPC)
- Integration of Armed Forces

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: How did fighting Nazi racism abroad push the U.S. to confront racism at home? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how WWII changed economic and social conditions for African Americans. Give at least two specific examples.

Words you need before we read

Executive Order 8802

En español: *Orden Ejecutiva 8802*

WHAT IT MEANS

The June 1941 order signed by President Roosevelt banning racial discrimination in the defense industry and creating the Fair Employment Practices Committee.

Double V Campaign

En español: *Campaña de la Doble V*

WHAT IT MEANS

A World War II campaign led by the Black press calling for a 'Double Victory' - over fascism abroad and racial discrimination at home.

Tuskegee Airmen

En español: *Aviadores de Tuskegee*

WHAT IT MEANS

First African American military pilots who fought in World War II, proving their skill despite facing racial discrimination and segregation.

Check your understanding

What was the "Double V" campaign, and how did it connect the fight against fascism abroad with civil rights at home?

- A** The Pittsburgh Courier's campaign demanded victory over fascism abroad and over racism at home, arguing that fighting for democracy overseas exposed the contradiction of denying democracy to Black Americans ✓ KEY
- B** It focused only on military victory, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which does not align with the documented historical record, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C** It supported segregation, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality
- D** It had no connection to civil rights, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.54

Japanese American Internment & Korematsu

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the constitutional issues and impact of the internment of Japanese Americans on the U.S., including the Fred Korematsu v. United States of America decision.

I CAN

I can describe the constitutional issues and impact of the internment of Japanese Americans on the U.S., including the Fred Korematsu v. United States of America decision.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.53 What was the 'Double V' campaign?

2

US.53 What did Executive Order 8802 do?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What group was forced into internment camps after Pearl Harbor?

✓ **ANSWER**

Japanese Americans, most of them U.S. citizens.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

After Pearl Harbor, the U.S. government forced more than 110,000 Japanese Americans, most of them U.S. citizens, from their homes into remote internment camps, and the Supreme Court said it was legal.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When the nation is at war, how far can the government go in taking away the rights of its own citizens?

US.54 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Japanese Internment

Internamiento Japonés

say: *jap-uh-NEEZ in-TERN-ment*

The forced relocation and incarceration of 120,000 Japanese Americans (two-thirds U.S. citizens) in concentration camps during WWII, based on racial prejudice, not evidence of disloyalty.

Korematsu v. United States

Korematsu contra Estados Unidos

say: *kor-eh-MAT-soo*

1944 Supreme Court decision upholding Japanese internment as a wartime necessity, later widely condemned as one of the Court's worst decisions.

Executive Order 9066

Orden Ejecutiva 9066

say: *eg-ZEK-yuh-tiv OR-der*

The February 1942 order signed by President Roosevelt authorizing the military to exclude and relocate Japanese Americans from the West Coast.

442nd Regimental Combat Team

442º Equipo de Combate Regimental

say: *for-for-tee-SEK-und rej-ih-MEN-tul*

All Japanese-American unit that became the most decorated unit in U.S. military history, fighting in Europe while their families were interned at home.

Pearl Harbor

Pearl Harbor

say: *purl HAR-ber*

Japan's surprise attack on the U.S. naval base in Hawaii on December 7, 1941, killing over 2,400 Americans and bringing the United States into World War II.

Totalitarianism

Totalitarismo

say: *toh-tal-ih-TAIR-ee-uh-niz-um*

A system of government where the state controls every aspect of public and private life, using propaganda, secret police, and terror to eliminate opposition.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

US.54 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

1 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Executive Order 9066 and Internment

- Following Pearl Harbor, Executive Order 9066 (February 1942) authorized removal of persons from designated military areas, leading to internment of approximately 120,000 Japanese Americans—two-thirds of whom were U.S. citizens.
- Families were forced to abandon homes, businesses, and property, often selling possessions at severe losses.
- They were transported to remote internment camps surrounded by barbed wire and guard towers, losing their civil liberties based solely on ancestry.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Executive Order 9066 led to _____, which raised the constitutional issue of _____.



Dorothea Lange / War Relocation Authority / National Archives and Records Administration, May 8, 1942 [National Archives](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Constitutional Issues

- Internment violated fundamental constitutional principles: due process (no individual hearings or evidence of disloyalty), equal protection (restrictive racial classification treating all Japanese Americans as suspects), and arguably habeas corpus (detention without charges).
- No similar mass detention was imposed on German or Italian Americans, highlighting the racial basis of the policy.
- Civil liberties groups protested, but wartime hysteria and racism overcame constitutional protections.

Korematsu v. United States (1944)

- Fred Korematsu refused to report for internment and was arrested.
- The Supreme Court upheld the exclusion order 6-3, ruling that wartime necessity justified the racial classification.
- Justice Frank Murphy's dissent called the decision "legalization of racism." The decision was widely criticized and formally repudiated decades later.
- In 1983, Korematsu's conviction was vacated after evidence emerged that the government had suppressed evidence contradicting military necessity claims.

Impact and Historical Lessons

- Internees lost an estimated \$400 million in property and suffered lasting psychological trauma.
- The Civil Liberties Act of 1988 formally apologized and provided \$20,000 reparations to surviving internees.
- Historical lessons emphasize the danger of racial profiling during wartime, the importance of judicial review protecting civil liberties, and how fear can override constitutional protections.
- The internment serves as a cautionary example still invoked in contemporary civil liberties debates.

Key Figures

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President; signed EO 9066

- Signed Executive Order 9066 (1942)
- Authorized removal of ~120,000 Japanese Americans
- Most were U.S. citizens never charged with any crime

STRATEGY Present EO 9066 as documented action, then let the Murphy dissent supply the constitutional counter-argument.

Justice Frank Murphy

Supreme Court dissenter in Korematsu

- Dissented forcefully in Korematsu v. U.S. (1944)
- Called internment a descent into 'the ugly abyss of racism'
- Gave students the constitutional case against internment

STRATEGY Use Murphy's dissent to model evidence-based constitutional argument.

US.54 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Executive Order 9066

Close Reading

President Franklin D. Roosevelt • February 19, 1942

"I hereby authorize and direct the Secretary of War, and the Military Commanders whom he may from time to time designate... to prescribe military areas in such places and of such extent as he or the appropriate Military Commander may determine, from which any or all persons may be excluded."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

After Japan attacked Pearl Harbor in December 1941, anti-Japanese sentiment surged on the West Coast of the United States. Military leaders and politicians claimed Japanese Americans could not be trusted and might commit acts of sabotage. Executive Order 9066 authorized the military to relocate and intern approximately 120,000 people of Japanese ancestry—most of them American citizens—in camps throughout the interior of the country.

ANALYZE

What power did Executive Order 9066 grant to military authorities?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSP.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

President Franklin D. Roosevelt

WHEN?

February 19, 1942

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Let's Work One Together

Build a constitutional argument

MODEL PROMPT: Was internment constitutional? What does the evidence show?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

EO 9066 authorized removal; Korematsu upheld it; Murphy's dissent called it racism. Weigh the wartime-necessity claim against the rights of citizens never charged.

THINK ALOUD

Find one line defending internment and one line attacking it.

→ **Now you try:** *State your position and support it with a specific quote.*

US.54 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Liberty on Trial — Japanese American Internment and Korematsu

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Executive Order 9066 and study the Mochida family photograph. Complete a four-part organizer: (1) what EO 9066 ordered; (2) the CONSTITUTIONAL ISSUES it raised; (3) the ruling in Korematsu v. United States (1944); (4) the IMPACT and later lessons (the 1988 apology and reparations). Add one detail per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim on when, if ever, national security can justify limiting citizens' rights.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-part organizer (order / constitutional issues / Korematsu ruling / impact, one detail each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about rights and security.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the four parts pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort.
Honors: Write a paragraph using the Mochida family photograph and EO 9066 to argue whether the Korematsu decision protected or betrayed the Constitution.

Companion printable: cornell-notes/unit-6/us54-japanese-internment-korematsu.pdf

US.54 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

Read the excerpt below.

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

"The forced relocation of Japanese Americans from the West Coast is a military necessity. We cannot distinguish loyal from disloyal in wartime." — General John DeWitt, Testimony Before Congress, 1943

Which of the following best describes the policy toward Japanese Americans described in

- A** Japanese Americans voluntarily relocated to inland communities to avoid potential anti-Japanese violence on the West Coast.
- B** Japanese diplomats and nationals were expelled from the United States after Pearl Harbor as enemy aliens.
- C** Approximately 120,000 Japanese Americans, most of them citizens, were forcibly removed from their homes and confined to internment camps.
- D** All Asian Americans were required to register with the federal government and carry identification cards during the war.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

Read the excerpt below.

✓ ANSWER KEY

"The forced relocation of Japanese Americans from the West Coast is a military necessity. We cannot distinguish loyal from disloyal in wartime." — General John DeWitt, Testimony Before Congress, 1943

Which of the following best describes the policy toward Japanese Americans described in this

- A** Japanese Americans voluntarily relocated to inland communities to avoid potential anti-Japanese violence on the West Coast.
- B** Japanese diplomats and nationals were expelled from the United States after Pearl Harbor as enemy aliens.
- C** **Approximately 120,000 Japanese Americans, most of them citizens, were forcibly removed from their homes and confined to internment camps.** ✓
- D** All Asian Americans were required to register with the federal government and carry identification cards during the war.

Correct answer: C. Why: Following Executive Order 9066 signed by President Roosevelt in 1942, approximately 120,000 Japanese Americans — two-thirds of whom were American citizens — were forcibly relocated to internment camps for the duration of the war. This policy was later condemned as a violation of civil liberties; the Civil Liberties Act of 1988 issued a formal apology and redress.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Executive Order 9066 and Internment
- Constitutional Issues
- Korematsu v. United States (1944)
- Impact and Historical Lessons

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 • SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: When, if ever, can national security justify limiting the rights of citizens?
Defend your position with evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe the internment of Japanese Americans and the constitutional issues it raised, including Korematsu v. United States.

Words you need before we read

Japanese Internment

En español: *Internamiento Japonés*

WHAT IT MEANS

The forced relocation and incarceration of 120,000 Japanese Americans (two-thirds U.S. citizens) in concentration camps during WWII, based on racial prejudice, not evidence of disloyalty.

Korematsu v. United States

En español: *Korematsu contra Estados Unidos*

WHAT IT MEANS

1944 Supreme Court decision upholding Japanese internment as a wartime necessity, later widely condemned as one of the Court's worst decisions.

Executive Order 9066

En español: *Orden Ejecutiva 9066*

WHAT IT MEANS

The February 1942 order signed by President Roosevelt authorizing the military to exclude and relocate Japanese Americans from the West Coast.

Check your understanding

How did Executive Order 9066 violate constitutional principles of due process and equal protection?

- A** It followed all constitutional procedures, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- B** It denied due process by detaining people without individual hearings or evidence, and violated equal protection by targeting Japanese Americans while not similarly treating German or Italian Americans ✓ KEY
- C** It only affected non-citizens, but the historical record tells a more complex story, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- D** The Constitution does not protect against internment, which does not align with the documented historical record, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.55

Home Front Mobilization

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the war's impact on the home front, including: rationing, bond drives, propaganda, movement to cities and industrial centers, Bracero program, conversion of factories for wartime production, location of prisoner of war camps in Tennessee.

I CAN

I can describe the war's impact on the home front, including rationing, bond drives, propaganda, movement to cities, the Bracero program, conversion of factories, and prisoner of war camps in Tennessee.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.54 What did Executive Order 9066 authorize?

2

US.54 What did the Supreme Court rule in Korematsu v. United States (1944)?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Name one way American civilians conserved resources for the war.

✓ **ANSWER**

Rationing (or victory gardens, scrap drives, or buying war bonds).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

World War II reached into every American kitchen and back yard: families rationed sugar and gas, bought war bonds, planted victory gardens, and turned car factories into tank factories almost overnight.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did a war fought on other continents transform daily life for ordinary Americans on the home front?

US.55 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Rationing

say: RASH-un-ing

Racionamiento

Government-controlled limits on consumer goods during WWII to ensure adequate supplies for the military, requiring ration books and coupons.

Rosie the Riveter

say: ROH-zee thuh RIV-eh-ter

Rosie la Remachadora

Cultural icon representing millions of American women who worked in factories and shipyards during World War II, filling jobs left by men who went to war.

Allied Powers

say: AL-yd POW-erz

Potencias Aliadas

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

War Bonds

say: wor bondz

Bonos de Guerra

Government bonds sold to citizens to finance the war effort, promoted through massive publicity campaigns featuring celebrities and patriotic appeals.

Manhattan Project

say: man-HAT-un PROJ-ekt

Proyecto Manhattan

Top-secret U.S. program to develop the atomic bomb, involving sites at Oak Ridge (Tennessee), Los Alamos (New Mexico), and Hanford (Washington).

Executive Order 8802

say: eg-ZEK-yuh-tiv OR-der

Orden Ejecutiva 8802

The June 1941 order signed by President Roosevelt banning racial discrimination in the defense industry and creating the Fair Employment Practices Committee.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

US.55 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

1 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Rationing and Conservation

- Ration books with coupons controlled civilian access to gasoline, tires, sugar, meat, coffee, and other commodities.
- This ensured military supplies while distributing scarce goods fairly.
- Victory gardens encouraged citizens to grow their own vegetables, while scrap drives collected metal, rubber, and other materials.
- These programs fostered civilian investment in the war effort and created shared sacrifice that built national unity.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

On the home front, Americans supported the war by _____, _____, and _____.



Marjory Collins / U.S. OWI, June 1943 [Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

War Bonds and Propaganda

- Liberty and Victory bonds financed the war while giving civilians a direct stake in victory.
- Bond drives featured celebrities and patriotic appeals, raising billions of dollars.
- The Office of War Information coordinated propaganda through films, posters, and radio, boosting morale and labor recruitment.
- Propaganda portrayed the enemy as evil while celebrating American values and workers' contributions.

Migration, Factory Conversion, and Bracero Program

- Millions migrated to defense industry centers, creating housing shortages and demographic shifts that reshaped American cities.
- Auto plants converted to tank and aircraft factories through rapid retooling that enabled massive production increases.
- The Bracero Program (1942) brought contract labor from Mexico to fill agricultural shortages, providing economic benefits while creating exploitation issues that would persist for decades.

Tennessee's Wartime Role

- Tennessee hosted significant wartime facilities including POW camps that housed Axis prisoners, providing labor for local agriculture and industry.
- Camp Forrest and other installations trained troops and processed prisoners.
- Most significantly, Oak Ridge was secretly built to enrich uranium for the Manhattan Project, making Tennessee crucial to developing the atomic bomb.
- These facilities transformed Tennessee's economy and population.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee played a major home-front role in World War II. The state hosted large training installations such as Camp Forrest and prisoner-of-war camps that held Axis prisoners, whose labor supported local agriculture and industry, tying communities across Tennessee directly to the war effort.

Key Figure

The American Home Front

Civilians, 1941-1945

- Accepted rationing of gas, sugar, meat, and rubber
- Bought war bonds and planted victory gardens
- Moved to boomtowns for defense work

STRATEGY Keep the home front concrete: one ration book, one victory garden, one defense paycheck.

US.55 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

War Ration Book Instructions

Sourcing

Office of Price Administration • 1943

"This book is your Government's guarantee of your fair share of goods made scarce by war. Price ceilings and rationing are the most fair way to distribute scarce goods. Misuse of rationing stamps is a crime punishable by fine or imprisonment. Your Government needs your compliance."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

During World War II, the U.S. government managed shortages of everyday goods by introducing rationing. Items like meat, butter, sugar, gasoline, and rubber were in short supply because they were needed for the war effort. The Office of Price Administration issued ration books to ensure that every American family received a fair share, and it became a symbol of the home front sacrifice that civilians were asked to make.

ANALYZE

According to this document, why did the government implement rationing?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSP.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

Office of Price Administration

WHEN?

1943

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Let's Work One Together

Explain home-front mobilization

MODEL PROMPT: How did ordinary civilians help win the war?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Rationing freed supplies for the military, war bonds funded the effort, and victory gardens eased shortages. Small daily choices scaled up to national power.

THINK ALOUD

List three specific home-front sacrifices from the section.

→ **Now you try:** *Rank them by impact and defend your top choice with evidence.*

US.55 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Everyone Serves — Mobilizing the Home Front

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Study the War Ration Book and the victory-garden photograph. Build a chart of home-front mobilization covering rationing and conservation, war bonds and propaganda, migration and factory conversion and the Bracero program, and Tennessee's wartime role (including POW camps). Write one sentence on how each helped the war effort. Finish with a one-sentence claim on how the war reached into the daily lives of ordinary Americans, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed home-front chart (one-sentence contribution each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the war's reach into daily life.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the mobilization categories pre-labeled and a word bank to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using the ration book and victory-garden image to explain how the government turned civilians into active participants in the war.

Companion printable: cornell-notes/unit-6/us55-home-front-mobilization.pdf

US.55 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

Read the excerpt below.

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

"Americans are asked to observe meatless Tuesdays, wheatless Wednesdays, and to grow their own vegetables in Victory Gardens. The victory begins at your dinner table." — Office of Price Administration Bulletin, 1943

Which of the following best describes the purpose of rationing and Victory Gardens on

- A** To combat wartime inflation by reducing the prices of food and consumer goods for all Americans.
- B** To redirect essential resources to the military effort and build civilian morale by involving all Americans in the war effort.
- C** To compensate for the federal government's failure to organize an effective agricultural production system.
- D** To reduce dependence on imports from Europe by encouraging domestic food production.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

Read the excerpt below.

✓ ANSWER KEY

"Americans are asked to observe meatless Tuesdays, wheatless Wednesdays, and to grow their own vegetables in Victory Gardens. The victory begins at your dinner table." — Office of Price Administration Bulletin, 1943

Which of the following best describes the purpose of rationing and Victory Gardens on the

- A** To combat wartime inflation by reducing the prices of food and consumer goods for all Americans.
- B** To redirect essential resources to the military effort and build civilian morale by involving all Americans in the war effort. ✓
- C** To compensate for the federal government's failure to organize an effective agricultural production system.
- D** To reduce dependence on imports from Europe by encouraging domestic food production.

Correct answer: B. Why: Rationing and Victory Gardens were part of the home front mobilization to redirect key resources — meat, wheat, rubber, gasoline, metals — from civilian consumption to military use. They also helped manage potential food shortages and build civilian morale by making every American feel they were part of the war effort.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Rationing and Conservation
- War Bonds and Propaganda
- Migration, Factory Conversion, and Bracero Program
- Tennessee's Wartime Role

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: How much did the home front's effort contribute to Allied victory compared with the fighting itself? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe how the war mobilized the American home front. Give at least three specific examples.

Words you need before we read

Rationing

En español: *Racionamiento*

WHAT IT MEANS

Government-controlled limits on consumer goods during WWII to ensure adequate supplies for the military, requiring ration books and coupons.

War Bonds

En español: *Bonos de Guerra*

WHAT IT MEANS

Government bonds sold to citizens to finance the war effort, promoted through massive publicity campaigns featuring celebrities and patriotic appeals.

Rosie the Riveter

En español: *Rosie la Remachadora*

WHAT IT MEANS

Cultural icon representing millions of American women who worked in factories and shipyards during World War II, filling jobs left by men who went to war.

Check your understanding

What role did propaganda play in maintaining civilian morale and support for the war effort?

- A** Propaganda was not used during WWII, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B** Propaganda only targeted military personnel, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C** **The Office of War Information used films, posters, and radio to demonize enemies, celebrate American values, recruit workers, and build national unity through shared purpose and sacrifice** ✓ KEY
- D** Propaganda undermined the war effort, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.56

Manhattan Project & Atomic Bomb

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the Manhattan Project and explain the rationale for using the atomic bomb to end the war.

I CAN

I can describe the Manhattan Project and explain the rationale for using the atomic bomb to end the war.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.55 Name two ways Americans supported the war on the home front.

2

US.55 What was one of Tennessee's wartime roles?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What secret project built the atomic bomb, with a key site in Tennessee?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Manhattan Project, with a major site at Oak Ridge.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the hills of Oak Ridge, Tennessee, and the deserts of New Mexico, tens of thousands of workers built the most powerful, and most terrifying, weapon in human history, most of them never knowing what they were making.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Was dropping the atomic bomb a justified way to end the war and save lives, or the opening of a dangerous new age?

US.56 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Manhattan Project

Proyecto Manhattan

say: man-HAT-un PROJ-ekt

Top-secret U.S. program to develop the atomic bomb, involving sites at Oak Ridge (Tennessee), Los Alamos (New Mexico), and Hanford (Washington).

Atomic Bomb

Bomba Atómica

say: uh-TOM-ik bom

Nuclear weapons dropped on Hiroshima (August 6) and Nagasaki (August 9, 1945), killing over 200,000 people and forcing Japan's surrender, ending World War II.

Battle of Iwo Jima

Batalla de Iwo Jima

say: BAT-ul uv EE-woh JEE-muh

February-March 1945 brutal battle for a strategic Pacific island, famous for the iconic flag-raising photograph on Mount Suribachi.

Allied Powers

Potencias Aliadas

say: AL-yd POW-erz

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

Hideki Tojo

Hideki Tojo

say: hee-DEH-kee TOH-joh

Japanese military leader and Prime Minister (1941-1944) who led Japan into World War II and authorized the attack on Pearl Harbor.

Pearl Harbor

Pearl Harbor

say: purl HAR-ber

Japan's surprise attack on the U.S. naval base in Hawaii on December 7, 1941, killing over 2,400 Americans and bringing the United States into World War II.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

US.56 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

1 of 4 ● ● ● ●

Oak Ridge, Tennessee Selection

- Oak Ridge was selected for uranium enrichment because of its remote location providing security isolation, abundant electrical power from TVA, good transportation access, and available land.
- The "Secret City" grew to 75,000 residents, most unaware of their work's purpose.
- Oak Ridge produced enriched uranium for the "Little Boy" bomb dropped on Hiroshima, making Tennessee crucial to the atomic bomb's development.

SENTENCE FRAME *(EL & writing support)*

The Manhattan Project _____, and Truman used the atomic bomb because _____.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

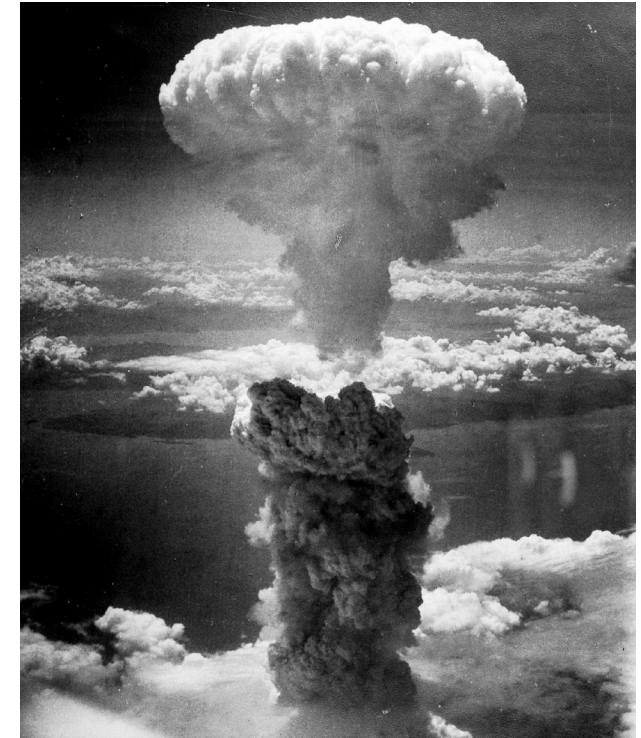
Oak Ridge, Tennessee was chosen as a secret Manhattan Project site for uranium enrichment because of its remote, secure location, abundant TVA electrical power, good rail access, and available land. The 'Secret City' grew almost overnight to tens of thousands of workers, most of whom never knew they were helping build the atomic bomb.

Manhattan Project Overview

- The secret multi-site program included Los Alamos (weapon design), Oak Ridge (uranium enrichment), and Hanford (plutonium production).
- Led by General Leslie Groves and scientist J. Robert Oppenheimer, the project employed over 125,000 people and cost nearly \$2 billion.
- The Trinity test (July 16, 1945) successfully demonstrated the first nuclear explosion in New Mexico, proving the concept worked.

Rationale for Using Atomic Weapons

- President Truman authorized atomic bombs to end the war quickly, avoiding a costly invasion of Japan projected to cause hundreds of thousands of American casualties based on Okinawa experience.
- Additional factors included forcing rapid Japanese surrender, demonstrating American power to the Soviet Union, and justifying the massive investment in the Manhattan Project.
- The bombs on Hiroshima (August 6) and Nagasaki (August 9) killed over 100,000 immediately, with more dying later from radiation.



Charles Levy / U.S. Army Air Forces / National Archives and Records Administration, August 9, 1945 [National Archives](#)

Ethical Debate

- Arguments for use included ending the war quickly, saving lives on both sides that invasion would cost, and Japanese refusal to surrender despite conventional bombing.
- Arguments against included the targeting of civilians, long-term radiation effects, potential alternatives like demonstration or modified surrender terms, and the precedent of nuclear warfare.
- This debate continues among historians and ethicists, with no consensus on whether the decision was justified.

Key Figure

Harry S. Truman

33rd President (1945-1953)

- Took office in April 1945 after FDR's death
- Learned of the atomic bomb only as president
- Ordered the bombings of Hiroshima and Nagasaki

STRATEGY Use Truman to frame the atomic decision as a real leader weighing invasion casualties against the bomb.

US.56 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Statement on the Atomic Bomb

Close Reading

President Harry S. Truman • August 6, 1945

"Sixteen hours ago an American airplane dropped one bomb on Hiroshima, an important Japanese Army base. That bomb had more power than 20,000 tons of T.N.T.. We are now prepared to obliterate more rapidly and completely every productive enterprise the Japanese have above ground in any city... If they do not now accept our terms they may expect a rain of ruin from the air."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

By August 1945, World War II in Europe had ended but fierce fighting continued in the Pacific. Estimates projected that a land invasion of Japan could cost hundreds of thousands of American and Japanese lives. President Truman made the decision to use the newly developed atomic bomb—the product of the secret Manhattan Project—hoping to force Japan's surrender without an invasion. The first bomb was dropped on Hiroshima on August 6, 1945, killing approximately 80,000 people instantly.

ANALYZE

What ultimatum does Truman issue to Japan in this statement?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSR.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

President Harry S. Truman

WHEN?

August 6, 1945

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Harry S. Truman Presidential Library](#)

Let's Work One Together

Evaluate a high-stakes decision

MODEL PROMPT: What was Truman's rationale for using the atomic bomb?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Truman argued the bomb would end the war fast and avoid a costly invasion of Japan. Weigh that stated rationale against the human cost of Hiroshima and Nagasaki.

THINK ALOUD

Underline Truman's stated reason in the source.

→ **Now you try:** *Judge whether the rationale justified the decision, citing evidence.*

US.56 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

The Weight of the Decision — The Manhattan Project and the Bomb

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Truman's statement on the atomic bomb and use your notes to complete a four-part organizer: (1) why OAK RIDGE, TENNESSEE was selected; (2) an overview of the MANHATTAN PROJECT; (3) the RATIONALE for using the bomb to end the war; (4) the ETHICAL DEBATE that followed. Add one detail per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim, backed by evidence, on whether the decision to drop the bomb was justified.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-part organizer (Oak Ridge / project overview / rationale / ethical debate, one detail each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the decision.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the four parts pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort.
Honors: Write a paragraph using Truman's statement to weigh the argument that the bomb saved lives against the argument that it caused unjustifiable civilian deaths.

Companion printable: cornell-notes/unit-6/us56-manhattan-project-atomic-bomb.pdf

US.56 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

The Manhattan Project's Oak Ridge, Tennessee facility was critical to the atomic bomb because —

- A Oak Ridge housed the scientists who designed the bomb's explosive mechanism.
- B It was the site of the Trinity test where the bomb was first detonated.
- C It was where the bombs were assembled and tested.
- D Oak Ridge's Y-12 and K-25 plants enriched uranium.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

The Manhattan Project's Oak Ridge, Tennessee facility was critical to the atomic bomb because —

- A** Oak Ridge housed the scientists who designed the bomb's explosive mechanism.
- B** It was the site of the Trinity test where the bomb was first detonated.
- C** It was where the bombs were assembled and tested.
- D** Oak Ridge's Y-12 and K-25 plants enriched uranium. ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: Oak Ridge's Y-12 and K-25 plants enriched uranium. The United States secretly developed nuclear weapons, which changed warfare and diplomacy after 1945. A is incorrect because it describes a different program, event, or idea than this World War II event. This helps explain how World War II became a turning point in modern science and warfare.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Oak Ridge, Tennessee Selection
- Manhattan Project Overview
- Rationale for Using Atomic Weapons
- Ethical Debate

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was the decision to drop the atomic bomb justified? Defend your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe the Manhattan Project and explain the rationale for using the atomic bomb.

Words you need before we read

Manhattan Project

En español: *Proyecto Manhattan*

WHAT IT MEANS

Top-secret U.S. program to develop the atomic bomb, involving sites at Oak Ridge (Tennessee), Los Alamos (New Mexico), and Hanford (Washington).

Atomic Bomb

En español: *Bomba Atómica*

WHAT IT MEANS

Nuclear weapons dropped on Hiroshima (August 6) and Nagasaki (August 9, 1945), killing over 200,000 people and forcing Japan's surrender, ending World War II.

Battle of Iwo Jima

En español: *Batalla de Iwo Jima*

WHAT IT MEANS

February-March 1945 brutal battle for a strategic Pacific island, famous for the iconic flag-raising photograph on Mount Suribachi.

Check your understanding

What factors influenced President Truman's decision to use atomic weapons against Japan?

- A** Truman made the decision without considering alternatives, which does not align with the documented historical record, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- B** Only military factors were considered, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C** Truman opposed using the bombs, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** Projected invasion casualties based on Okinawa, desire to end the war quickly, demonstrating power to the Soviet Union, and Japanese refusal to surrender all influenced the decision ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.57

Yalta and Potsdam Conferences

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the major outcomes of the Yalta and Potsdam Conferences.

I CAN

I can explain the major outcomes of the Yalta and Potsdam Conferences.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.56 What was the Manhattan Project?

2

US.56 What was the main rationale for using the atomic bomb?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Name one of the two major Allied conferences that planned the postwar world.

✓ **ANSWER**

The Yalta Conference or the Potsdam Conference (both 1945).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

As victory neared, the leaders of the United States, Britain, and the Soviet Union met at Yalta and Potsdam to divide up the postwar world, and in the process planted the seeds of the Cold War.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When allies win a war together but distrust one another, how do the peace they make and the lines they draw shape the decades that follow?

US.57 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

Yalta Conference

Conferencia de Yalta

say: YAWL-tuh KON-fer-ens

February 1945 meeting of Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin to plan post-war Europe, dividing Germany and establishing spheres of influence.

Potsdam Conference

Conferencia de Potsdam

say: POTS-dam KON-fer-ens

July-August 1945 meeting of Truman, Churchill/Attlee, and Stalin finalizing plans for occupied Germany and issuing surrender terms to Japan.

Joseph Stalin

Joseph Stalin

say: JOH-zef STAH-lin

Communist dictator of the Soviet Union (1924-1953) who ruled through terror, forced collectivization, and purges, resulting in millions of deaths.

Atomic Bomb

Bomba Atómica

say: uh-TOM-ik bom

Nuclear weapons dropped on Hiroshima (August 6) and Nagasaki (August 9, 1945), killing over 200,000 people and forcing Japan's surrender, ending World War II.

Allied Powers

Potencias Aliadas

say: AL-yd POW-erz

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

Axis Powers

Potencias del Eje

say: AK-sis POW-erz

Military alliance of Germany, Italy, and Japan during World War II. United by shared goals of territorial expansion, militarism, and opposition to democratic nations.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Yalta Conference (February 1945)

- Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin met as Allied victory approached.
- Major agreements included UN formation plans, division of Germany into occupation zones, and Soviet entry into the war against Japan.
- Controversially, Stalin promised "free elections" in liberated Eastern Europe—a promise he would break.
- The conference also addressed reparations from Germany and arrangements for post-war Poland.
- Roosevelt sought Soviet cooperation for the post-war order.

SENTENCE FRAME *(EL & writing support)*

At Yalta and Potsdam the Allies agreed to _____, but disagreed over _____, which helped start the Cold War.



U.S. Army Signal Corps / U.S. Federal Government, February 1945
[National Archives](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Potsdam Conference (July-August 1945)

- Truman (replacing the deceased Roosevelt), Churchill (replaced mid-conference by Attlee), and Stalin met as Germany surrendered.
- The conference confirmed occupation zones, issued the Potsdam Declaration ultimatum to Japan demanding unconditional surrender, and agreed on German demilitarization and denazification.
- Tensions over Eastern Europe and reparations surfaced, revealing the growing divide between Soviet and Western visions for post-war Europe.

Cold War Origins

- Disagreements over Eastern Europe proved irreconcilable.
- Stalin's interpretation of "free elections" meant communist-controlled governments, while the West expected genuine democratic choice.
- Soviet occupation of Eastern Europe created what Churchill would call the "Iron Curtain." German reparations disputes, with the Soviets stripping their zone of industrial equipment, deepened mistrust.
- These wartime conferences set the stage for the Cold War division of Europe.

Assessment of Allied Diplomacy

- Critics argue Roosevelt conceded too much to Stalin at Yalta, though defenders note Soviet armies already occupied Eastern Europe and FDR sought Soviet help against Japan.
- Truman took a harder line at Potsdam but faced the same reality of Soviet military control.
- Whether better outcomes were possible remains debated—the fundamental conflict between Soviet security concerns and Western democratic values may have made Cold War inevitable regardless of conference diplomacy.

Key Figures

Franklin D. Roosevelt

32nd President; at Yalta

- Met Churchill and Stalin at Yalta (Feb 1945)
- Sought Soviet help against Japan and a postwar UN
- Died before the Potsdam Conference

STRATEGY Use FDR at Yalta and Truman at Potsdam to show continuity and change in Allied diplomacy.

Harry S. Truman

33rd President; at Potsdam

- Represented the U.S. at Potsdam (July-Aug 1945)
- Issued the Potsdam Declaration demanding Japan's surrender
- Faced rising tension with Stalin over postwar Europe

STRATEGY Contrast Potsdam's hardening tone with Yalta to preview the coming Cold War.

US.57 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

Yalta Conference Communiqué

Argumentation

Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin • February 1945

"We have agreed on common policies and plans for enforcing the unconditional surrender terms which we shall impose together on Nazi Germany... It is our inflexible purpose to destroy German militarism and Nazism and to ensure that Germany will never again be able to disturb the peace of the world."

READ CLOSELY *Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.*

CONTEXT

In February 1945, with Germany's defeat approaching, the leaders of the three main Allied powers—Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin—met at Yalta in Soviet Crimea to plan the post-war world. They made key decisions about Germany's defeat and occupation, the establishment of the United Nations, and the future of Eastern Europe. Many historians see Yalta as marking the beginning of tensions that would become the Cold War, as Stalin soon violated promises about free elections in Eastern Europe.

ANALYZE

What was the shared goal of the Allied leaders at Yalta regarding Germany?

SOURCE IT
FIRST

SSR.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?

Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin

WHEN?

February 1945

WHY does it matter?

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: *Avalon Project, Yale Law School*

Let's Work One Together

Summarize diplomatic
outcomes

MODEL PROMPT: What did the Allies decide at Yalta and Potsdam?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Yalta planned the UN, Soviet entry against Japan, and a divided Germany; Potsdam hardened terms and demanded Japan's surrender. Cooperation was already fraying into rivalry.

THINK ALOUD

List one outcome from each conference.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain one seed of the coming Cold War planted at these meetings.*

US.57 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Dividing the Postwar World — Yalta and Potsdam

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Yalta Communique and review the Big Three photograph. Build a two-column chart: YALTA (Feb 1945) outcomes and POTSDAM (July-Aug 1945) outcomes, listing the leaders present and at least two decisions from each. Then note one way these conferences planted seeds of the Cold War. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether the Allies cooperated or already distrusted one another, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed two-conference chart (leaders + 2 decisions each, plus one Cold War seed) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about Allied unity.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart pre-labeled 'Yalta' and 'Potsdam' with a word bank of decisions and leaders to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using the Yalta Communique to explain how wartime agreements over Poland and Eastern Europe helped spark the Cold War.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us57-yalta-potsdam.pdf](https://www.troopstoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-6/us57-yalta-potsdam.pdf)

US.57 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

"The leaders of the Allied powers — Churchill, Roosevelt, and Stalin — met at Yalta to determine the shape of the post-war world. Each came with different goals, and each left with only part of what he wanted." — Historian Robert Dallek, Franklin D. Roosevelt: A Political Life, 2017

- A** Plans for dividing Germany into occupation zones, establishing the United Nations, and the Soviet Union's entry into the Pacific War.
- B** The decision to use atomic bombs on Japan to force a rapid end to the Pacific War.
- C** The Marshall Plan to provide economic aid to war-devastated European nations to prevent communist takeover.
- D** The division of Korea at the 38th parallel into Soviet and American spheres of influence.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

"The leaders of the Allied powers — Churchill, Roosevelt, and Stalin — met at Yalta to determine the shape of the post-war world. Each came with different goals, and each left with only part of what he wanted." — Historian Robert Dallek, Franklin D. Roosevelt: A Political Life, 2017

- A** Plans for dividing Germany into occupation zones, establishing the United Nations, and the Soviet Union's entry into the Pacific War. ✓
- B** The decision to use atomic bombs on Japan to force a rapid end to the Pacific War.
- C** The Marshall Plan to provide economic aid to war-devastated European nations to prevent communist takeover.
- D** The division of Korea at the 38th parallel into Soviet and American spheres of influence.

Correct answer: A. Why: At the Yalta Conference, the Big Three (Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin) agreed on plans for the postwar world, including the division of Germany into occupation zones, free elections in liberated Eastern European countries (a promise Stalin later broke), the creation of the United Nations, and a Soviet pledge to declare war on Japan.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Yalta Conference (February 1945)
- Potsdam Conference (July-August 1945)
- Cold War Origins
- Assessment of Allied Diplomacy

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did the Allies genuinely cooperate at Yalta and Potsdam, or had the Cold War already begun? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain the major outcomes of the Yalta and Potsdam Conferences and how they contributed to the Cold War.

Words you need before we read

■ Yalta Conference

En español: *Conferencia de Yalta*

WHAT IT MEANS

February 1945 meeting of Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin to plan post-war Europe, dividing Germany and establishing spheres of influence.

■ Potsdam Conference

En español: *Conferencia de Potsdam*

WHAT IT MEANS

July-August 1945 meeting of Truman, Churchill/Attlee, and Stalin finalizing plans for occupied Germany and issuing surrender terms to Japan.

■ Joseph Stalin

En español: *Joseph Stalin*

WHAT IT MEANS

Communist dictator of the Soviet Union (1924-1953) who ruled through terror, forced collectivization, and purges, resulting in millions of deaths.

Check your understanding

How did the Potsdam Conference reveal growing tensions between the United States and Soviet Union?

A Disputes over Eastern European governments, German reparations, and differing visions for post-war Europe revealed fundamental disagreements that would define the Cold War

✓ KEY

B Potsdam showed complete Allied unity, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era

C Only minor disagreements emerged, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

D The Soviet Union was excluded from Potsdam, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

STANDARD

US.58

Founding of the United Nations & Cordell Hull

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Identify and explain the reasons for the founding of the United Nations, including the role of Cordell Hull.

I CAN

I can identify and explain the reasons for the founding of the United Nations, including the role of Cordell Hull.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.57 Where did the 'Big Three' meet in early 1945 to plan the postwar world?

2

US.57 How did Yalta and Potsdam help start the Cold War?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What international organization was founded in 1945 to keep the peace?

✓ **ANSWER**

The United Nations.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Determined not to repeat the failure of the League of Nations, the Allies, led in part by Tennessean Cordell Hull, built a new global organization, the United Nations, to keep the peace after the deadliest war in history.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why did the League of Nations fail, and could a new United Nations succeed where it had not?

US.58 · KEY VOCABULARY

Word Wall

United Nations

United Nations

say: yoo-NY-ted NAY-shunz

An international organization founded in 1945 by 50 nations to maintain global peace, security, and cooperation and to prevent another world war through collective diplomacy.

Cordell Hull

Cordell Hull

say: kor-DEL hul

U.S. Secretary of State under Franklin D. Roosevelt (1933-1944), awarded the 1945 Nobel Peace Prize for his role in creating the United Nations.

Yalta Conference

Conferencia de Yalta

say: YAWL-tuh KON-fer-ens

February 1945 meeting of Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin to plan post-war Europe, dividing Germany and establishing spheres of influence.

Allied Powers

Potencias Aliadas

say: AL-yd POW-erz

The World War II coalition led by the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union that fought and defeated the Axis Powers.

Four Freedoms Speech

Discurso de las Cuatro Libertades

say: for FREE-dumz speech

FDR's 1941 speech defining American war aims: freedom of speech, freedom of worship, freedom from want, and freedom from fear.

Holocaust

Holocausto

say: HOL-uh-kawst

Nazi Germany's systematic genocide of 6 million Jews and millions of others (Roma, disabled, homosexuals, political opponents) during World War II.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) supports newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Lessons from League of Nations Failure

- The League of Nations failed because the United States never joined, it lacked enforcement mechanisms, major powers could ignore it, and it couldn't prevent aggression by Germany, Italy, and Japan.
- Planners sought to avoid these weaknesses in a new organization.
- American participation would be essential, and the new organization needed stronger enforcement authority, particularly through the Security Council with major power veto and potential for military action.

SENTENCE FRAME *(EL & writing support)*

The United Nations was founded to _____, and it tried to avoid the League of Nations' failure by _____.

Cordell Hull's Role

- Cordell Hull, FDR's Secretary of State and a Tennessean, was instrumental in planning the United Nations.
- He advocated for international organization throughout the war, led U.S. delegation efforts in preliminary planning, and helped shape UN principles.
- His decades of work promoting international cooperation earned him the Nobel Peace Prize in 1945, making him one of Tennessee's most significant contributions to world history.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Cordell Hull, a Tennessean and FDR's long-serving Secretary of State, was so central to planning the postwar peace organization that he is often called the 'Father of the United Nations.' He won the 1945 Nobel Peace Prize for his work, a lasting Tennessee connection to the founding of the UN.

US.58 · DIRECT INSTRUCTION

3 of 4 ● ● ● ●

UN Goals and Structure

- The United Nations was designed to maintain international peace and security through collective action, develop friendly relations among nations based on equal rights and self-determination, promote social progress and human rights, and facilitate international cooperation on economic and humanitarian issues.
- The Security Council with five permanent members (US, UK, France, China, USSR) had primary responsibility for peace and security, with veto power ensuring major power buy-in.



Unknown photographer / United Nations, January 1, 1942
[Wikimedia Commons](#)

UN Legacy and Limitations

- The UN successfully avoided the League's fate—American membership was secured, and the organization has survived.
- However, Cold War rivalry often paralyzed the Security Council through vetoes.
- The UN has been most effective in humanitarian work, peacekeeping in conflicts where major powers agree, and establishing international norms through declarations and treaties.
- Its limitations in preventing great power conflicts reflect the inherent challenges of international organization.

Key Figure

Cordell Hull

Secretary of State (1933-1944)

- Called the 'Father of the United Nations'
- Laid the diplomatic groundwork for the UN
- Won the 1945 Nobel Peace Prize

STRATEGY Use Hull to show that the UN grew out of deliberate American planning, not accident.

US.58 • PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS

United Nations Charter Preamble

Close Reading

United Nations • June 26, 1945

"We the peoples of the United Nations determined to save succeeding generations from the scourge of war, which twice in our lifetime has brought untold sorrow to mankind, and to reaffirm faith in fundamental human rights, in the dignity and worth of the human person, in the equal rights of men and women and of nations large and small."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

The United Nations was founded in June 1945, just weeks after Germany's surrender and before Japan's. The world had just survived two devastating world wars in thirty years, and world leaders were determined to create an international body that could prevent future conflicts. Representatives of 50 nations signed the UN Charter in San Francisco, establishing an organization designed to promote peace, human rights, and international cooperation.

ANALYZE

According to the UN Charter, what was the primary motivation for creating the United Nations?

SOURCE IT FIRST

SSR.02 • before you interpret

WHO made it?
United Nations

WHEN?
June 26, 1945

WHY does it matter?
Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: United Nations

Let's Work One Together

Explain the purpose of an institution

MODEL PROMPT: Why did the Allies build the United Nations?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Having seen appeasement and total war fail to keep peace, leaders wanted a permanent forum to resolve disputes. The UN Charter's preamble states that goal directly.

THINK ALOUD

Find the preamble's stated purpose for the UN.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain how the UN was meant to fix what the 1930s got wrong.*

US.58 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

Never Again — Building the United Nations

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the UN Charter Preamble and study the Declaration by United Nations photograph. Complete a four-part organizer: (1) the LESSONS learned from the League of Nations' failure; (2) CORDELL HULL's role as 'Father of the United Nations'; (3) the UN's GOALS and basic STRUCTURE; (4) the UN's LEGACY and LIMITATIONS. Add one detail per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether the UN corrected the weaknesses that doomed the League, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-part organizer (League lessons / Hull's role / goals-structure / legacy-limits, one detail each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim comparing the UN to the League.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the four parts pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort.
Honors: Write a paragraph using the UN Charter Preamble to argue whether the UN's design fixed the specific flaws that made the League of Nations powerless.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-6/us58-united-nations-cordell-hull.pdf](https://www.cornellnotes.com/unit-6/us58-united-nations-cordell-hull.pdf)

US.58 · CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did the experiences of World War II most directly influence the founding of the United Nations in 1945?

- A** The war demonstrated that economic competition between nations was the root cause of all conflicts, requiring a global trade body.
- B** The failure of the League of Nations and the devastation of WWII showed the need for a stronger international organization to maintain peace.
- C** Allied leaders created the United Nations primarily to coordinate the occupation of defeated Germany and Japan.
- D** The development of nuclear weapons convinced world leaders that a global government with military authority over all nations was necessary.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the experiences of World War II most directly influence the founding of the United Nations in 1945?

- A** The war demonstrated that economic competition between nations was the root cause of all conflicts, requiring a global trade body.
- B** The failure of the League of Nations and the devastation of WWII showed the need for a stronger international organization to maintain peace. ✓
- C** Allied leaders created the United Nations primarily to coordinate the occupation of defeated Germany and Japan.
- D** The development of nuclear weapons convinced world leaders that a global government with military authority over all nations was necessary.

Correct answer: B. Why: The League of Nations had failed to prevent WWII, and the war's unprecedented death toll demonstrated that international cooperation to prevent future conflicts was essential; Cordell Hull and others championed the UN as a reformed, stronger version of collective security to replace the failed League of Nations.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Lessons from League of Nations Failure
- Cordell Hull's Role
- UN Goals and Structure
- UN Legacy and Limitations

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: Did the UN's design truly fix the flaws that doomed the League of Nations?
Argue with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain why the United Nations was founded and how it aimed to avoid the failures of the League of Nations.

Words you need before we read

United Nations

En español: *United Nations*

WHAT IT MEANS

An international organization founded in 1945 by 50 nations to maintain global peace, security, and cooperation and to prevent another world war through collective diplomacy.

Cordell Hull

En español: *Cordell Hull*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. Secretary of State under Franklin D. Roosevelt (1933-1944), awarded the 1945 Nobel Peace Prize for his role in creating the United Nations.

Yalta Conference

En español: *Conferencia de Yalta*

WHAT IT MEANS

February 1945 meeting of Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin to plan post-war Europe, dividing Germany and establishing spheres of influence.

Check your understanding

What were the main goals of the United Nations, and how did they reflect wartime experiences?

A The UN had no connection to WWII experiences, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

B **Goals of maintaining peace, promoting human rights, enabling self-determination, and fostering cooperation directly addressed the failures that led to WWII—aggression, human rights violations, and economic nationalism**

✓ KEY

C The UN focused only on trade issues, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era

D Wartime experiences were irrelevant to UN design, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Unit 6 Complete

World War II (1919–1945) · from the rise of fascism, communism, and totalitarianism and the attack on Pearl Harbor to the war fronts, the home front, the atomic bomb, and the founding of the United Nations.

Revisit your unit hook: How did the U.S. move from neutrality to total war, and what did victory cost? You can now answer with evidence — from the Neutrality Acts and Pearl Harbor to D-Day and Midway, from Rosie the Riveter and the Double V campaign to Japanese American internment, and from the Manhattan Project to Yalta, Potsdam, and the UN.

Next: Unit 7 — The Cold War & Postwar America